Chapter 20 — Cheat Sheets and Glossary

This last chapter compresses Chapters 1–19 into pages you can scan in a minute. There is one **cheat sheet** per area of the language and platform, a **feature-by-version table** for Java 17 → 25, the build and test **commands** you type every day, an **index of the interview questions** answered in Chapter 19, a short **"where next"** guide, and an alphabetical **glossary** of 340+ terms, each linked to the section that explains it properly.

Nothing here is new. If a line doesn't make sense, follow its link back to the full explanation. References look like **§10.5**, meaning Chapter 10, section 5.

What you'll learn: how to use this chapter as a revision tool. Read a sheet, cover the right-hand column, and try to say the answer before you look. The glossary is a good last check before an interview: if you can't define a term in one sentence, follow its link.

Every concrete value on the sheets is tested. Primitive ranges, the `Integer` cache, the string pool, collection behaviours, stream results, `BigDecimal` and `java.time` edge cases, concurrency results and more are asserted by `code/ch20/CheatsheetChecks.java` (package `ch20`), compiled with `javac --release 25` and run on JDK 26 by the book's runner (`bash tools_run_java.sh java`). A failed check throws `AssertionError`. Real output:

```
OK   20.1 syntax, types, primitives           29 checks
OK   20.2 operators & precedence              16 checks
OK   20.3 control flow & patterns             12 checks
OK   20.4 methods & arrays                    16 checks
OK   20.5 OOP                                 13 checks
OK   20.6 core APIs                           45 checks
OK   20.7 exceptions                          12 checks
OK   20.8 generics                             7 checks
OK   20.9 collections                         28 checks
OK   20.10 functional interfaces & Optional   12 checks
OK   20.11 streams & collectors               18 checks
OK   20.12 I/O & NIO.2                        11 checks
OK   20.13 concurrency                        13 checks
OK   20.14 JVM                                9 checks
OK   20.15 modern Java 17-25                  9 checks
all 250 checks passed on Java 26
```

The helper is three small methods — `eq(actual, expected, label)`, `yes(condition, label)` and `throwsA(ExceptionType.class, code, label)` — because Java's own `assert` keyword is switched off unless you run `java -ea` (§19.1). A few lines as a taste:

```
Integer i1 = 127, i2 = 127, i3 = 128, i4 = 128;
eq(i1 == i2, true, "Integer cache -128..127");
eq(i3 == i4, false, "outside the cache: different objects");
throwsA(IllegalStateException.class, () -> emps.stream().collect(Collectors.toMap(Emp::dept, Emp::name)),
        "toMap duplicate key throws");
eq(LocalDate.of(2024, 1, 31).plusMonths(1), LocalDate.of(2024, 2, 29), "plusMonths clamps to month end");
```

What's inside

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20.1 Syntax, types and primitive ranges

Program shapes (§1.5, §1.10, §4.9):

```
// Classic: file Hello.java, class name = file name
public class Hello {
    public static void main(String[] args) { System.out.println("Hi " + args.length); }
}

// Java 25 compact source file (JEP 512): no class declaration, instance main, java.lang.IO
void main() { IO.println("Hi"); }
```

Command	Does	Since
`javac Hello.java` → `java Hello`	compile to `Hello.class`, then run it on the JVM	1.0
`javac -d out $(find src -name '*.java')` → `java -cp out pkg.Main`	compile a tree into `out/`, run with a class path	—
`java Hello.java`	compile in memory and run a single source file	11
`java Main.java` (other files next to it)	launch a multi-file source program	22
`jshell`	interactive REPL: type expressions, see results	9
`javap -c Hello`	disassemble bytecode	—

Basic rules (§2.1): statements end with `;`; blocks use `{}`; Java is case-sensitive; identifiers start with a letter, `_` or `$` (a lone `_` is not a name — since 22 it means "unnamed"); comments are `//`, `/* */` and `/** Javadoc */` (Markdown `///` doc comments since 23). Naming: `ClassName`, `methodAndVariable`, `CONSTANT_NAME`, `com.example.pkg`. Contextual keywords — `var`, `record`, `sealed`, `non-sealed`, `permits`, `yield`, `when`, `module` — are keywords only in their positions.

The eight primitives (§2.3) — everything else is a reference type (§2.5):

Type	Bits	Range	Default (fields)	Literal
`byte`	8	−128 … 127	`0`	`(byte) 1`
`short`	16	−32 768 … 32 767	`0`	`(short) 1`
`int`	32	−2 147 483 648 … 2 147 483 647 (±2.1 × 10^9)	`0`	`42`, `0x2A`, `0b101010`, `052`, `1_000_000`
`long`	64	−9 223 372 036 854 775 808 … 9 223 372 036 854 775 807 (±9.2 × 10^{18})	`0L`	`42L`
`float`	32	±3.4028235 × 10^{38}, ~7 significant digits	`0.0f`	`3.14f`
`double`	64	±1.7976931348623157 × 10^{308}, ~15–16 digits	`0.0`	`3.14`, `1e-9`
`char`	16	0 … 65 535 (unsigned UTF-16 code unit)	`'\u0000'`	`'A'`, `'\n'`, `'\u0041'`
`boolean`	—	`true`, `false`	`false`	`true`

- `Double.MIN_VALUE` (4.9E-324) is the smallest **positive** double; the most negative is `-Double.MAX_VALUE`.
- Fields get defaults (`0`, `false`, `null`); **local variables don't** — reading one before assigning it is a compile error (§2.2).
- Money: `long` cents or `BigDecimal`, never `double` (§2.11).

Conversions (§2.7):

Rule	Example	Result
Widening is automatic: `byte → short → int → long → float → double`, `char → int`	`long l = 42;`	ok
Narrowing needs a cast and keeps the low bits	`(byte) 200`	`-56`
Casting a floating value to an integer truncates toward zero	`(int) 3.99`	`3`
Arithmetic promotes `byte` / `short` / `char` to `int`	`byte b = 10; b = b + 1;`	compile error
Compound assignment hides a cast	`byte b = 10; b += 300;`	`54`
`char` is a number	`(int) 'A'`, `(char) ('a' + 1)`	`65`, `'b'`

Integer and floating-point facts (§2.10, §2.11):

Expression	Value	Why
`Integer.MAX_VALUE + 1`	`-2147483648`	silent wrap-around; use `Math.addExact` to get an `ArithmeticException`
`7 / 2`, `-7 / 2`	`3`, `-3`	integer division truncates toward zero
`-7 % 3` / `Math.floorMod(-7, 3)`	`-1` / `2`	`%` takes the dividend's sign
`7 / 2.0`	`3.5`	one `double` operand → `double` arithmetic
`0.1 + 0.2`	`0.30000000000000004`	binary fractions can't represent 0.1 exactly
`1.0 / 0`, `0.0 / 0`, `1 / 0`	`Infinity`, `NaN`, `ArithmeticException`	floats have special values; ints throw
`Double.NaN == Double.NaN`	`false`	test with `Double.isNaN`

`var` (Java 10, §2.6): local variables with an initializer only (also in `for` loops and lambda parameters); not for fields, parameters or return types; `var x = null;` and `var a = {1, 2};` don't compile. The type is fixed at compile time — `var` is not dynamic typing.

Text blocks (Java 15, §2.12): `"""` + newline opens; common indentation is stripped (the closing `"""` position counts); a closing delimiter on its own line adds a trailing `\n`; `\` at line end joins lines; `\s` keeps a trailing space.

Console I/O (§2.13, §13.8): `System.out.println/print/printf`; input with `Scanner(System.in)` (`nextInt`, `nextLine` — beware the leftover newline), `BufferedReader`, or `IO.readln("prompt")` in Java 25. `System.console()` returns `null` without an interactive terminal (IDEs, pipes) — always check it (Java 22–24 briefly returned a JLine-based console even then; 25 reverted).

20.2 Operators and precedence

From highest to lowest (§2.8, §2.9). Operands are always evaluated **left to right**; associativity only decides grouping.

Level	Operators	Associativity
1 Postfix	`x++` `x--`	left
2 Unary	`++x` `--x` `+` `-` `~` `!` `(type)`	right
3 Multiplicative	`*` `/` `%`	left
4 Additive	`+` `-` (and `String` `+`)	left
5 Shift	`<<` `>>` `>>>`	left
6 Relational	`<` `>` `<=` `>=` `instanceof`	left
7 Equality	`==` `!=`	left
8–10 Bitwise	`&` then `^` then `|`	left
11–12 Logical	`&&` then `||` (short-circuit)	left
13 Ternary	`? :`	right
14 Assignment, lambda	`=` `+=` `-=` `*=` `/=` `%=` `&=` `|=` `^=` `<<=` `>>=` `>>>=` `->`	right

Memory hook: **unary → multiply → add → shift → compare → equal → bitwise → logical → ternary → assign.**

Expression	Value	Lesson
`2 + 3 * 4`	`14`	`*` before `+`
`10 - 4 - 3`	`3`	left-associative
`1 + 2 + "3" + 4 + 5`	`"3345"`	numbers add until the first `String`, then everything concatenates
`true || false && false`	`true`	`&&` binds tighter than `||`
`x & 1 == 0`	compile error for `int x`	`==` binds tighter than `&` — write `(x & 1) == 0`
`i = 5; i++ + ++i`	`12`	`5 + 7`; never write this in real code
`-8 >> 1`, `-8 >>> 28`	`-4`, `15`	`>>` keeps the sign, `>>>` fills with zeros
`5 ^ 3`, `~5`, `1 << 10`	`6`, `-6`, `1024`	XOR, complement (−(n+1)), shift = ×2ⁿ
`a = b = c = 7`	all `7`	assignment is right-associative
`s != null && s.length() > 0` with `s = null`	`false`, no exception	`&&` stops at the first `false`
`o instanceof String str && str.length() == 4`	`true` for `"text"`	pattern variable in scope after `&&` (Java 16)

`==` on objects compares **references**; use `equals` for content (§6.13, §7.6).

20.3 Control flow, `switch` and patterns

Branches and loops (§3.1, §3.8, §3.9):

Construct	Shape	Notes
`if` / `else if` / `else`	`if (cond) { … } else { … }`	condition must be `boolean` — `if (1)` doesn't compile
Ternary	`cond ? a : b`	an expression; keep it short
`for`	`for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)`	index loops
Enhanced `for`	`for (String s : list)`	arrays and any `Iterable`; can't remove safely inside
`while` / `do … while`	test first / body runs at least once	
`break` / `continue`	leave / skip to next iteration of the innermost loop	`break outer;` / `continue outer;` with a label

The four `switch` shapes (§3.2, §3.3, §3.4):

Shape	Falls through?	Produces a value?	Must be exhaustive?
Statement, `case X:`	**yes** — until `break`	no	no (unless it uses patterns or `null`)
Statement, `case X ->` (14)	no	no	no (same exception)
Expression, `case X ->` (14)	no	yes; blocks use `yield`	**yes**
Expression, `case X:` + `yield`	yes	yes	yes

```
String type = switch (day) {
    case 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 -> "weekday";
    case 6, 7 -> "weekend";
    default -> { yield "invalid"; }
};
```

Selector types: `int` and smaller (`char`, `byte`, `short`) and their wrappers, `String`, enums — and, with patterns (21), **any reference type**. `long`, `float`, `double` and `boolean` selectors need *primitive patterns*, which are still **preview** in Java 25.

Pattern matching (§3.5, §3.6, §3.7):

Feature	Syntax	Final in
Type pattern in `instanceof`	`if (o instanceof String s && !s.isEmpty())`	16
Type pattern in `switch`	`case Integer i ->`	21
Guard	`case Integer i when i < 0 ->`	21
`null` label	`case null ->` or `case null, default ->`	21
Record pattern (nestable)	`case Point(int x, int y) when x == y ->`	21
`var` in a record pattern	`case Point(var x, var y) ->`	21
Unnamed pattern / variable	`case Point(var x, _) ->`, `catch (Exception _)`, `for (var _ : list)`	22

Rules to remember: without `case null`, a `null` selector throws `NullPointerException`; the first matching label wins, and a label that can never match (dominated, e.g. `CharSequence` before `String`) is a compile error; a pattern `switch` must be exhaustive — add `default` or cover every permitted subtype of a **sealed** type:

```
sealed interface Shape permits Circle, Square {}
record Circle(double r) implements Shape {}
record Square(double side) implements Shape {}

static double area(Shape s) {
    return switch (s) {                // no default needed: the compiler knows all subtypes
        case Circle c -> Math.PI * c.r() * c.r();
        case Square q -> q.side() * q.side();
    };
}
```

Loop pitfalls (§3.10): off-by-one (`<=` vs `<`), modifying a collection inside for-each (→ `ConcurrentModificationException`), `float` loop counters, `==` on strings in conditions, and infinite `while` loops whose variable never changes.

20.4 Methods and arrays

Methods (§4.1–§4.5):

Topic	Rule
Signature	name + parameter types (not the return type, not parameter names)
Passing	**always by value**; for objects the value is a copy of the reference — the callee can mutate the object but not rebind the caller's variable
Overload resolution	phase 1: exact match or widening; phase 2: boxing/unboxing; phase 3: varargs. `over(5)` with `over(long)`, `over(Integer)`, `over(int...)` picks `long`
Varargs	`int... nums` is an `int[]`; must be the last parameter; one per method; zero arguments allowed
`return`	a non-`void` method must return on every path
Recursion	needs a base case; each call adds a stack frame → `StackOverflowError` if too deep (Java has no tail-call elimination)
`static`	called on the class, has no `this` (§5.5)

Arrays (§4.6, §4.7):

```
int[] a = new int[3];             // [0, 0, 0] — elements get default values
int[] b = {3, 1, 2};              // initializer
String[] names = new String[2];   // [null, null]
int[][] grid = new int[3][4];     // rectangular
int[][] jagged = {{1}, {2, 3}, {}};  // rows of different lengths
a.length                           // a field, not a method; fixed forever
```

Index `0 … length − 1`; anything else → `ArrayIndexOutOfBoundsException`. Arrays are objects: `a.equals(b)` and `==` compare identity; `a.toString()` prints something like `[I@1b6d3586`.

`java.util.Arrays` (§4.8):

Method	Does	Example result
`toString(a)` / `deepToString(m)`	print 1D / nested	`[1, 2, 3]`, `[[1], [2, 3], []]`
`equals(a, b)` / `deepEquals`	compare contents	`true` for `{3,1,2}` vs `{3,1,2}`
`sort(a)`, `sort(a, from, to)`, `sort(T[], cmp)`	sort in place (dual-pivot quicksort for primitives, stable merge sort — TimSort — for objects)	
`binarySearch(a, key)`	on a **sorted** array; not found → `-(insertionPoint) − 1`	`binarySearch([1,2,3], 5)` = `-4`
`copyOf(a, n)`, `copyOfRange(a, from, to)`	new array, padded with defaults	`copyOf([1,2,3], 5)` = `[1, 2, 3, 0, 0]`
`fill(a, v)`, `setAll(a, i -> …)`	set every element	
`asList(…)`	fixed-size `List` **view** of the array — `add` throws, `set` writes through	
`stream(a)`	`IntStream` / `Stream<T>`	
`mismatch(a, b)`, `compare(a, b)`	first differing index / lexicographic order (9)	

Command-line arguments: `args` is never `null` (empty array when none); all elements are `String`s; the program name is not included (§4.9).

20.5 OOP: classes, interfaces, records, enums and sealed types

Access modifiers (§5.6):

Modifier	Same class	Same package	Subclass (other package)	Everywhere
`private`	✓			
(none) package-private	✓	✓		
`protected`	✓	✓	✓ (through inheritance)	
`public`	✓	✓	✓	✓

Top-level classes can only be `public` or package-private; one `public` top-level class per file, named like the file.

Constructors and initialisation (§5.3, §5.10):

- If you write no constructor, the compiler adds a no-argument one; write any constructor and it doesn't.
- `this(...)` calls another constructor of the same class, `super(...)` the parent's; if you write neither, `super()` is inserted. Since **Java 25** (JEP 513) statements that don't use `this` — validation, computing arguments, assigning the class's own fields — may appear **before** `super(...)`/`this(...)`.
- Order: static fields and `static {}` blocks run **once**, in source order, when the class is initialised → for each `new`: parent constructor → instance field initialisers and `{}` blocks in source order → the rest of the constructor body.

`static` and `final` (§5.5, §5.8): `static` = one per class, shared; a static method has no `this`. `final` variable = assigned once; `final` method = can't be overridden; `final` class = can't be extended. `final` on a reference doesn't freeze the object.

Inheritance and overriding (§6.1–§6.4):

Overriding rule	Detail
Same signature	otherwise it's an overload; use `@Override` to let the compiler check
Return type	same or a subtype (covariant)
Access	same or wider (`protected` → `public` ok, not the reverse)
Checked exceptions	same, narrower or none — never new or broader
Not overridable	`private`, `static` (hidden instead), `final` methods; constructors
Dispatch	instance methods use the object's run-time class; fields and static methods use the compile-time type

```
class Base    { static String who() { return "Base"; }    String me() { return "Base"; }
                String call() { return me() + "/" + who(); } }
class Derived extends Base { static String who() { return "Derived"; }
                @Override String me() { return "Derived"; } }
new Derived().call()   // "Derived/Base"
```

Choosing a type (§6.12):

Need	Use	Key facts
Mutable object with identity and lifecycle	**`class`** (`final` unless designed for extension)	full control of encapsulation
Shared state/code for a family of related classes	**`abstract class`**	fields, constructors, any access; single inheritance; can't be instantiated (§6.5)
A capability many unrelated types can have	**`interface`**	many per class; `abstract`, `default` (8), `static` (8), `private` (9) methods; fields are `public static final` constants; no instance state (§6.6)
Immutable data where equal values are interchangeable	**`record`** (16)	private final fields, canonical constructor, accessors `x()`, `equals`/`hashCode`/`toString`; implicitly `final`; extends `Record`; no extra instance fields; compact constructor for validation (§6.8)
A fixed set of instances known at compile time	**`enum`**	fields, constructors (private), methods, per-constant bodies; `values()`, `valueOf`, `ordinal()`; `EnumSet`/`EnumMap` (§6.9)
A closed set of variants	**`sealed`** interface/class (17) + records	`permits` lists subtypes; each is `final`, `sealed` or `non-sealed`; exhaustive `switch` without `default` (§6.7)

```
record Range(int lo, int hi) {
    Range {                                          // compact constructor
        if (lo > hi) throw new IllegalArgumentException(lo + " > " + hi);
    }
}
new Point(1, 2).equals(new Point(1, 2))          // record Point(int x, int y): true;  toString() =
"Point[x=1, y=2]"
```

Nested types (§6.10, §6.11):

Kind	Declared	Has an outer instance?	Typical use
Static nested class	`static class Node` inside a class	no	helpers, builders, `Map.Entry`-like types — the default choice
Inner class	`class Itr` inside a class	yes (`Outer.this`)	iterators that read the outer object's fields
Local class	inside a method body	yes if in an instance method	one-off helper with a name
Anonymous class	`new Interface() { … }`	yes if in an instance method	one-off implementation with state or several methods
Lambda	`x -> …`	captures effectively final locals	single-method (functional) interfaces

Nested records, enums and interfaces are implicitly `static`.

`Object` methods contract (§6.13): `equals` must be reflexive, symmetric, transitive, consistent, and `false` for `null`; equal objects **must** have equal `hashCode`s; override both or neither (`Objects.equals`, `Objects.hash` help). `toString` defaults to `ClassName@hexHash`. Immutability recipe (§5.9): `final` class, `private final` fields, no setters, defensive copies in and out (`List.copyOf`), don't leak `this` from the constructor. Design-level treatment: LLD handbook.

20.6 Core APIs: String, numbers, dates

Strings (§7.1, §7.2) are immutable; every "modifying" method returns a new `String`.

Fact	Value
`"java" == "java"` (two literals)	`true` — both are the pooled object
`"java" == new String("java")`	`false` — `new` always makes a new object
`"java" == new String("java").intern()`	`true`
`"java" == part + "va"` (run time, `part = "ja"`)	`false`; `"ja" + "va"` (constants) is folded → `true`
`"Java".substring(1, 3)`	`"av"` — end index exclusive
`"a,b,,".split(",").length` / `split(",", -1)`	`2` / `4` — trailing empties dropped unless limit is negative
`"a.b".replace(".", "-")` / `replaceAll(".", "-")`	`"a-b"` / `"---"` — `replaceAll` takes a **regex**
`" ".isBlank()` / `" ".isEmpty()`	`true` / `false`
`compareTo`	negative, zero or positive — not necessarily −1/1

Everyday methods: `length`, `charAt`, `indexOf` (−1 if absent), `contains`, `startsWith`/`endsWith`, `substring`, `strip` (Unicode-aware; prefer to `trim`), `toLowerCase(Locale.ROOT)`, `equalsIgnoreCase`, `split`, `String.join`, `repeat` (11), `lines` (11), `formatted` (15), `chars`, `codePoints`.

Builders (§7.3): `StringBuilder` (mutable, not synchronised — use it for loops: `append`, `insert`, `reverse`, `deleteCharAt`, `setLength(0)`); `StringBuffer` (synchronised, legacy); `StringJoiner` / `String.join` / `Collectors.joining` for delimited lists. `s += x` in a loop is O(n²).

Formatting (§7.4): `String.format(Locale.US, "%5.2f|%-4s|%04d|%,d", 3.14159, "ab", 42, 1234567)` → `" 3.14|ab  |0042|1,234,567"`. Conversions `%s %d %f %e %x %c %b %n %%`; flags `-` left, `0` pad, `,` grouping, `+` sign; `%2$s` argument index. Always pass a `Locale` when the output is parsed by machines.

`Math` (§7.5):

Call	Result	Note
`Math.round(2.5)`, `Math.round(-2.5)`	`3`, `-2`	ties toward +∞; returns `long` for `double`
`Math.rint(2.5)`	`2.0`	ties to even
`Math.floorDiv(-7, 2)`, `floorMod(-7, 3)`	`-4`, `2`	round toward −∞
`Math.abs(Integer.MIN_VALUE)`	`-2147483648`	overflow! `absExact` throws
`Math.clamp(15, 0, 10)`	`10`	Java 21
`addExact`, `multiplyExact`, `toIntExact`, `powExact` (25)	throw `ArithmeticException` on overflow	
`Math.random()`	`double` in [0.0, 1.0)	prefer `RandomGenerator`

Wrappers and autoboxing (§7.6):

Fact	Detail
`Integer a = 127, b = 127; a == b`	`true` — `Integer.valueOf` caches **`−128 … 127`** (also `Short`, `Byte`, `Long`, `Character` ≤ 127, both `Boolean`s)
`Integer c = 128, d = 128; c == d`	`false` — always compare wrappers with `equals`
`int x = (Integer) null`	`NullPointerException` on unboxing
`list.remove(1)` vs `list.remove(Integer.valueOf(1))`	removes **index** 1 vs the **value** 1
`Integer.parseInt("ff", 16)`	`255`; bad input → `NumberFormatException`
`Boolean.parseBoolean("YES")`	`false` — only `"true"` (any case) is true

`BigInteger` / `BigDecimal` (§7.7): immutable, arbitrary precision.

Rule	Example
Build from a `String` (or `BigDecimal.valueOf(double)`)	`new BigDecimal("0.1").add(new BigDecimal("0.2"))` = `0.3`; `new BigDecimal(0.1)` = `0.1000000000000000055511…`
`equals` checks value **and scale**; `compareTo` checks value only	`2.0` vs `2.00`: `equals` false, `compareTo` 0 — so `HashSet<BigDecimal>` can hold both
Non-terminating division needs a scale or `MathContext`	`ONE.divide(valueOf(3))` → `ArithmeticException`; `divide(valueOf(3), 4, HALF_UP)` = `0.3333`
Rounding modes	`2.345` → `HALF_UP` `2.35`, `HALF_EVEN` (banker's) `2.34`
`BigInteger`	`BigInteger.TWO.pow(100)` has 31 digits

`java.time` (§7.8–§7.11) — immutable, thread-safe; months are 1–12:

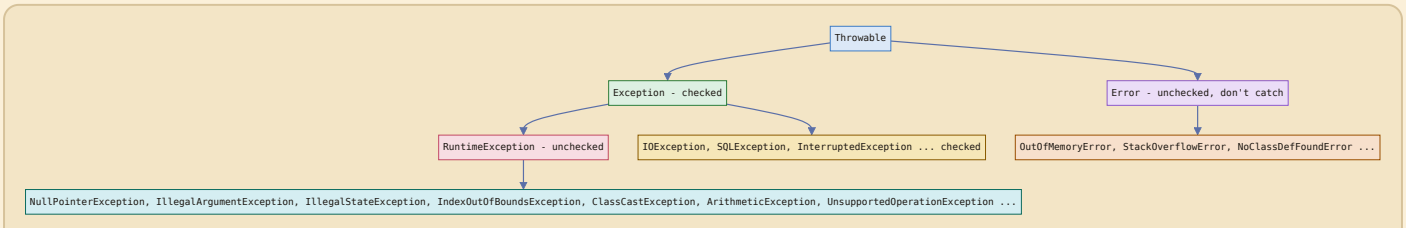
Class	Represents	Example
`LocalDate` / `LocalTime` / `LocalDateTime`	wall-calendar date/time, **no zone**	birthdays, opening hours
`ZonedDateTime`	date-time in a region (`ZoneId.of("Europe/Paris")`), DST-aware	meetings
`OffsetDateTime`	date-time with a fixed offset (`+02:00`)	API timestamps
`Instant`	a point on the UTC time-line	logs, DB timestamps
`Duration`	seconds + nanos (machine time)	`Duration.ofMinutes(90)` → `PT1H30M`
`Period`	years, months, days (calendar)	2024-01-15 → 2025-03-20 = `P1Y2M5D`
`DateTimeFormatter`	format/parse, thread-safe	`ofPattern("yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm")`

Edge cases (all checked): `LocalDate.of(2024, 1, 31).plusMonths(1)` → `2024-02-29` (clamped); in `America/New_York`, 2025-03-09 01:30 plus 1 hour → 03:30, and that day lasts 23 hours; `yyyy` vs `YYYY` for 2025-12-29 → `2025` vs `2026` (week-based year — a classic bug); `MM` month vs `mm` minute; `HH` 0–23 vs `hh` 1–12; `LocalDate.of(2025, 2, 29)` → `DateTimeException`. Legacy `Date`/`Calendar`/`SimpleDateFormat` are mutable and not thread-safe — convert at the edges.

Random numbers (§7.12): `new Random(42)` is reproducible (same seed → same sequence); `ThreadLocalRandom.current()` for concurrent code; `SecureRandom` for tokens and passwords; `RandomGenerator.of("L64X128MixRandom")` (17) for choosing an algorithm; `random.nextInt(lo, hi)` (17) excludes `hi`.

20.7 Exceptions

The hierarchy (§8.2):



Kind	Which classes	Compiler rule	Meaning
Checked	`Exception` and subclasses **except** the `RuntimeException` branch	must be caught or declared with `throws` (§8.3)	a recoverable problem outside the program's control (file, network, DB)
Unchecked	`RuntimeException` and subclasses	no rule	a programming error (bad argument, bad state, `null`)
Error	`Error` and subclasses (also unchecked)	no rule	the JVM or environment is in trouble — let it propagate

Common exception	Thrown when	Kind
`NullPointerException`	dereferencing `null` (helpful messages name the `null` part: Java 14, on by default since 15)	unchecked
`IllegalArgumentException` / `NumberFormatException`	bad argument / unparsable number	unchecked
`IllegalStateException`	object not in the right state (stream reused, `toMap` duplicate key)	unchecked
`ArrayIndexOutOfBoundsException`, `StringIndexOutOfBoundsException`	bad index	unchecked
`ClassCastException`, `ArithmeticException`	bad cast / integer `/ 0`, overflow in `*Exact`	unchecked
`UnsupportedOperationException`	mutating an unmodifiable collection	unchecked
`ConcurrentModificationException`	structural change during iteration	unchecked
`IOException`, `FileNotFoundException`, `NoSuchFileException`	I/O failure	**checked**
`InterruptedException`	a blocked thread was interrupted	**checked**
`SQLException`	JDBC failure	**checked**
`UncheckedIOException`	an `IOException` wrapped for lambdas/streams	unchecked

Syntax rules (§8.4–§8.6):

Construct	Rule
`try { } catch (A e) { } finally { }`	`catch` or `finally` (or both) required; `finally` runs on normal exit, exception, `return`, `break`
Catch order	subclasses before superclasses, else "exception has already been caught" compile error
Multi-catch `catch (A | B e)`	`A` and `B` must not be subtype-related; `e` is effectively final
`return` in `finally`	overrides the `try`'s return **and swallows exceptions** — never do it (`try { return 1; } finally { return 2; }` returns `2`)
try-with-resources `try (var r = open())`	any `AutoCloseable`; closed automatically in **reverse** order; a close failure is added as **suppressed** to the body's exception (`getSuppressed()`)
`finally` doesn't run	only if the JVM exits (`System.exit`, crash) or the thread never leaves `try`
Rethrow	`catch (Exception e) { throw e; }` — precise rethrow keeps the narrower checked types
Chaining	`throw new ServiceException("load failed", e)` — keep the cause (§8.8)

```
try (Res a = new Res("A", log); Res b = new Res("B", log)) {
    throw new RuntimeException("body failed");
}   // log: open A, open B, body, close B, close A — both close() failures become suppressed
```

Custom exceptions (§8.7): extend `Exception` (checked) or `RuntimeException` (unchecked); provide `(String message)` and `(String message, Throwable cause)` constructors; add fields for context.

Best practices (§8.10): throw early (validate arguments with `Objects.requireNonNull`, `IllegalArgumentException`), catch late (where you can really handle it); never swallow (`catch (Exception e) {}`); don't use exceptions for control flow; catch the most specific type; translate low-level

exceptions at layer boundaries and keep the cause; log **or** rethrow, not both; clean up with try-with-resources. Reading traces: the first line is the type and message, then frames newest-first; read `Caused by:` sections bottom-up to find the root (§8.9).

20.8 Generics and PECS

Syntax (§9.1–§9.5):

Form	Example
Generic class / record	`class Box<T> { T value; }`, `record Pair<A, B>(A first, B second) {}`
Generic interface	`interface Repository<T, ID> { Optional<T> findById(ID id); }`
Generic method	`static <T> List<T> repeat(T x, int n)` — type parameter before the return type
Explicit type argument	`Collections.<String>emptyList()` (rarely needed — inference)
Diamond	`Map<String, List<Integer>> m = new HashMap<>();`
Bounded type	`<T extends Number>`, several bounds: `<T extends Number & Comparable<T>>` (class first)
Recursive bound	`<T extends Comparable<? super T>> T max(List<? extends T> xs)`
Wildcards	`List<?>`, `List<? extends Number>`, `List<? super Integer>`

Naming convention: `T` type, `E` element, `K`/`V` key/value, `R` result, `ID` identifier.

Invariance and PECS (§9.6): `List<Integer>` is **not** a `List<Number>` (arrays are covariant and fail at run time with `ArrayStoreException`; generics refuse at compile time).

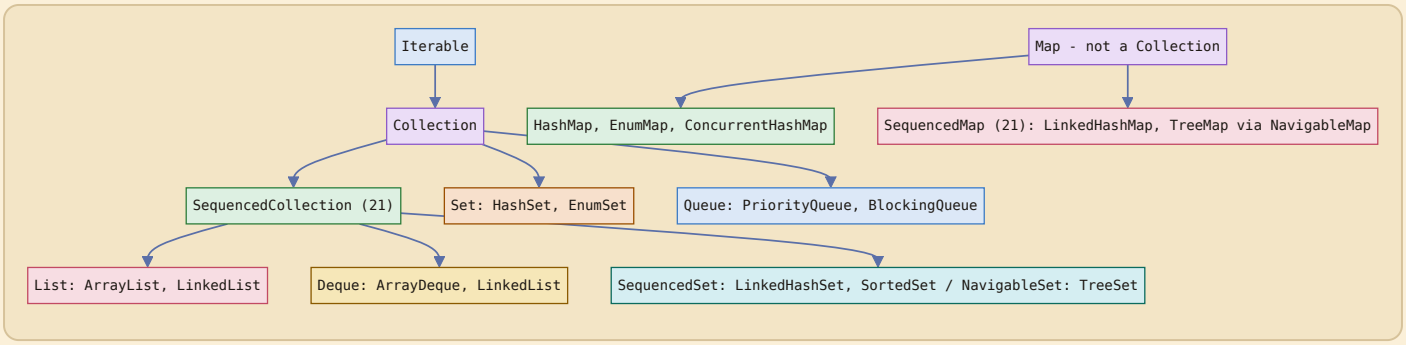
Wildcard	You can read as	You can add	Use when the parameter…	Example
`List<? extends Number>`	`Number`	nothing (except `null`)	**produces** values for you	`double sumAll(List<? extends Number> xs)`
`List<? super Integer>`	`Object`	`Integer`	**consumes** values you give it	`void fill(List<? super Integer> sink)` accepts `List<Number>`, `List<Object>`
`List<?>`	`Object`	nothing	you only use `Object` methods / size	`printAll(List<?> xs)`
`List<T>`	`T`	`T`	you both read and write	`swap(List<T> xs, int i, int j)`

Producer **E**xtends, **C**onsumer **S**uper — e.g. `Collections.copy(List<? super T> dest, List<? extends T> src)`. Don't use wildcards in return types.

Type erasure (§9.7, §9.8): generics are checked by the compiler, then erased to their bounds (`Object` if unbounded) with casts inserted. `new ArrayList<String>().getClass() == new ArrayList<Integer>().getClass()` is `true`. So you **can't**: use primitives (`List<int>`), `new T()`, `new T[n]`, `instanceof List<String>`, use `T` in static members, overload `f(List<String>)` with `f(List<Integer>)` (same erasure), or make a generic `Throwable`. Workarounds: `Supplier<T>` factories, `Class<T>` tokens, `List<T>` instead of `T[]`. Raw types (`List raw`) switch checking off — they exist only for pre-Java-5 code. Eliminate unchecked warnings; suppress only on the smallest scope with a comment; mark safe generic varargs methods `@SafeVarargs`.

20.9 Collections: big-O and which to choose

The hierarchy (§10.1):



Big-O (§10.12) — `*` amortised, `†` average (worst case O(log n) in a tree-ified bucket):

Collection	add at end	add/remove at front	get(i)	contains / get(key)	remove element	Order	null ?
`ArrayList`	O(1)*	O(n)	O(1)	O(n)	O(n)	index	yes
`LinkedList`	O(1)	O(1)	O(n)	O(n)	O(n)	index	yes
`ArrayDeque`	O(1)*	O(1)*	—	O(n)	O(n)	head → tail	**no**
`PriorityQueue`	O(log n)	`poll` O(log n), `peek` O(1)	—	O(n)	O(n)	heap (iteration unsorted)	no
`HashSet` / `HashMap`	O(1)†	—	—	O(1)†	O(1)†	none	one `null` key
`LinkedHashSet` / `LinkedHashMap`	O(1)†	—	—	O(1)†	O(1)†	insertion (or access)	one `null` key
`TreeSet` / `TreeMap`	O(log n)	—	—	O(log n)	O(log n)	sorted	no `null` keys (natural order)
`EnumSet` / `EnumMap`	O(1)	—	—	O(1)	O(1)	enum order	no
`CopyOnWriteArrayList`	O(n)	O(n)	O(1)	O(n)	O(n)	index	yes
`ConcurrentHashMap`	O(1)†	—	—	O(1)†	O(1)†	none	**no**

Which one? (§10.13) Key → value: `HashMap`; insertion order or LRU: `LinkedHashMap`; sorted or range queries: `TreeMap`. Unique elements: `HashSet` / `LinkedHashSet` / `TreeSet` by the same rule. Indexed or append: `ArrayList` (the default list). Stack or queue: `ArrayDeque` (not `Stack`, not `LinkedList`). "Smallest next": `PriorityQueue`. Enum keys: `EnumMap`/`EnumSet`. Fixed data: `List.of`/`Set.of`/`Map.of`. Shared between threads: `ConcurrentHashMap`, `CopyOnWriteArrayList`, `BlockingQueue`.

`HashMap` internals (§10.5): table of buckets, default capacity 16, load factor 0.75 (resize — double — when size > capacity × 0.75); index = `(h ^ (h >>> 16)) & (capacity − 1)`; collisions chain in a list that turns into a red-black tree past 8 entries once the table has ≥ 64 buckets; lookup = hash, then `equals`. Keys must have consistent `equals`/`hashCode` and must not change while in the map.

Unmodifiable vs views (§10.10):

Factory	Changes through it?	Sees later changes to the source?	`null` s
`List.of`, `Set.of`, `Map.of` (9)	no — `UnsupportedOperationException`	— (no source)	**rejected** (NPE); `Set.of("a","a")` → `IllegalArgumentException`
`List.copyOf` (10), `stream.toList()` (16)	no	no — a snapshot	`copyOf` rejects; `toList()` **allows** `null` (unlike `Collectors.toUnmodifiableList()`)
`Collections.unmodifiableList(src)`	no	**yes** — a read-only view	allowed
`Arrays.asList(array)`	`set` yes (writes through to the array); `add`/`remove` no	yes	allowed

API you use daily (§10.2–§10.6, §10.9, §10.11):

Want	Call	Result in the checks
Count words	`map.merge(w, 1, Integer::sum)`	`{a=1, b=3, c=1}` in a `TreeMap`
Group into lists	`map.computeIfAbsent(k, x -> new ArrayList<>()).add(v)`	
Default	`map.getOrDefault(k, -1)`	`-1`
Previous value	`map.put("a", 2)`	returns the old value (`null` if none)
Nearest keys	`treeMap.floorKey(25)`, `ceilingKey(25)` on {10, 20, 30}	`20`, `30`; `floorKey(5)` = `null`
Sub-ranges	`headMap(20)` / `tailMap(20)`	`[10]` / `[20, 30]` (head exclusive, tail inclusive)
Stack	`deque.push(x)`, `pop()`, `peek()`	`push` = `addFirst`
Queue	`deque.offer(x)`, `poll()`, `peek()`	`offer` = `addLast`; `poll` returns `null` when empty, `remove` throws
Min-heap / max-heap	`new PriorityQueue<>()` / `new PriorityQueue<>(Comparator.reverseOrder())`	`poll()` of {5, 1, 4}: `1` / `5`
LRU cache	`new LinkedHashMap<>(16, 0.75f, true)` + override `removeEldestEntry` → `size() > cap`	
Ends of an ordered collection (21)	`getFirst()`, `getLast()`, `addFirst`, `removeLast`, `reversed()`	`[x, y, z]` → `x`, `z`, `[z, y, x]`
Sort with several keys	`list.sort(comparing(String::length).thenComparing(reverseOrder()))`	`[fig, pear, kiwi, apple]`
Remove while iterating	`removeIf(pred)` or `iterator.remove()`	for-each + `list.remove` → `ConcurrentModificationException`
Utilities	`Collections.sort`, `reverse`, `shuffle`, `frequency`, `max`, `nCopies`, `emptyList`	

Ordering (§10.8): `Comparable<T>.compareTo` = the class's one natural order; `Comparator<T>` = any number of external orders (`comparing`, `thenComparing`, `reversed`, `nullsFirst`). Never compare by subtraction (`a - b` overflows) — use `Integer.compare`. `TreeSet`/`TreeMap` treat `compareTo == 0` as "equal", so keep it consistent with `equals`.

20.10 Functional interfaces, lambdas and `Optional`

`java.util.function` (§11.2, §11.3) — a *functional interface* has exactly one abstract method:

Interface	Shape	Method	Typical use
`Supplier<T>`	`() → T`	`get`	factories, lazy defaults, `orElseGet`
`Consumer<T>` / `BiConsumer<T,U>`	`T → void` / `(T,U) → void`	`accept`	`forEach`, `Map.forEach`
`Predicate<T>` / `BiPredicate<T,U>`	`T → boolean`	`test`	`filter`, `removeIf`
`Function<T,R>` / `BiFunction<T,U,R>`	`T → R` / `(T,U) → R`	`apply`	`map`, `computeIfAbsent`, `merge`
`UnaryOperator<T>` / `BinaryOperator<T>`	`T → T` / `(T,T) → T`	`apply`	`replaceAll`, `reduce`
`IntPredicate`, `IntFunction<R>`, `ToIntFunction<T>`, `IntUnaryOperator`, `IntBinaryOperator`, `IntSupplier`, `ObjIntConsumer<T>` …	primitive versions (also `Long…`, `Double…`)	`test`, `apply`, `applyAsInt`, `getAsInt` …	avoid boxing in hot code
`Runnable` / `Callable<V>`	`() → void` / `() → V`, may throw	`run` / `call`	tasks
`Comparator<T>`	`(T,T) → int`	`compare`	sorting

Lambda syntax: `() -> 42`, `x -> x * 2`, `(a, b) -> a + b`, `(String s) -> s.length()`, `(var x, var y) -> …`, block form `x -> { …; return r; }`. Captured local variables must be **effectively final** (assigned once) (§11.5); fields can change. `this` in a lambda is the enclosing object (in an anonymous class it's the anonymous object).

Method references (§11.4):

Kind	Syntax	Equivalent lambda
Static method	`Integer::sum`	`(a, b) -> Integer.sum(a, b)`
Bound instance (specific object)	`System.out::println`, `"*"::repeat`	`x -> System.out.println(x)`
Unbound instance (first argument is the receiver)	`String::toUpperCase`	`s -> s.toUpperCase()`
Constructor	`ArrayList::new`, `int[]::new`	`() -> new ArrayList<>()`

Composition (§11.6): `f.andThen(g)` runs `f` then `g`; `f.compose(g)` runs `g` then `f` (with `plus1`, `times2` on 3: `8` vs `7`); `Predicate.and/or/negate`, `Predicate.not(String::isBlank)` (11); `Function.identity()`; `Comparator.comparing(...).thenComparing(...)`.

`Optional<T>` (§11.7) — a return type for "maybe no result":

Do	Don't
`opt.map(f).filter(p).orElse(default)`	`opt.get()` without checking (→ `NoSuchElementException`)
`orElseGet(() -> expensive())` for costly defaults	`orElse(expensive())` — the argument is **always** evaluated
`orElseThrow()` (10) when absence is a bug	`Optional` fields, parameters, collection elements
`ifPresentOrElse`, `or`, `stream()` (9)	returning `null` from a method that returns `Optional`
return an empty collection for "no results"	`Optional<List<…>>`
`Optional.ofNullable(x)` for maybe-null values	`Optional.of(null)` (→ `NullPointerException`)
`OptionalInt`/`OptionalDouble` for primitives	`Optional<Integer>` in hot numeric code

20.11 Streams and collectors

A **stream** is a one-shot, lazy pipeline over a source: **source → zero or more intermediate operations → one terminal operation** (§12.1, §12.2). Nothing runs until the terminal operation; elements flow one at a time, and short-circuiting operations stop early:

```
Stream.of(1, 2, 3, 4).peek(x -> trace.add("saw " + x)).filter(x -> x > 1).findFirst();
// result 2, trace [saw 1, saw 2] — elements 3 and 4 are never touched
```

Stage	Operations
Sources	`coll.stream()`, `Stream.of(…)`, `Arrays.stream(a)`, `IntStream.range(0, n)` / `rangeClosed`, `Stream.iterate(seed, hasNext, next)` (9), `Stream.generate(s)`, `Files.lines(p)`, `str.chars()`, `map.entrySet().stream()`
Intermediate, stateless	`filter`, `map`, `mapToInt/Long/Double`, `mapToObj`, `boxed`, `flatMap`, `mapMulti` (16), `peek` (debugging only)
Intermediate, stateful	`distinct`, `sorted`, `limit`, `skip`, `takeWhile` / `dropWhile` (9), `gather(…)` (24)
Terminal	`forEach`, `collect`, `toList()` (16), `toArray`, `reduce`, `count`, `min`/`max`, `sum`/`average` (primitive streams), `findFirst`/`findAny`, `anyMatch`/`allMatch`/`noneMatch`

Terminal facts (§12.4): on an empty stream `anyMatch` → `false`, `allMatch` and `noneMatch` → `true`; `reduce(identity, op)` returns `T`, `reduce(op)` returns `Optional<T>`; `IntStream.average()` returns `OptionalDouble`; `Stream.toList()` is unmodifiable but accepts `null` elements; reusing a consumed stream → `IllegalStateException`.

Collectors (§12.5) — the examples use five employees (eng: Ann 120, Bob 100; ops: Cid 90, Dee 95; hr: Eve 80):

Collector	Result in the checks	Watch out
`groupingBy(Emp::dept, TreeMap::new, counting())`	`{eng=2, hr=1, ops=2}`	default map is a `HashMap` (no order)
`partitioningBy(e -> e.salary() >= 100, mapping(Emp::name, toList()))`	`{false=[Cid, Dee, Eve], true=[Ann, Bob]}`	always has both keys, even for an empty stream
`toMap(Emp::dept, Emp::name)`	`IllegalStateException`	duplicate keys throw; `null` values → NPE
`toMap(Emp::dept, Emp::salary, Math::max, TreeMap::new)`	`{eng=120, hr=80, ops=95}`	merge function resolves duplicates
`joining(", ", "[", "]")`	`[Ann, Bob, Cid, Dee, Eve]`	elements must be `CharSequence`
`counting()`, `summingInt`, `averagingDouble`, `minBy`, `maxBy`, `summarizingInt`	numbers, `Optional`, `IntSummaryStatistics`	usually as downstream collectors
`mapping`, `filtering` (9), `flatMapping` (9), `collectingAndThen`, `teeing` (12)	adapted results	
`toList()`, `toSet()`, `toUnmodifiableList()` (10), `toCollection(TreeSet::new)`	collections	`Collectors.toList()` mutability is unspecified

Primitive streams (§12.6): `IntStream`, `LongStream`, `DoubleStream` have `sum`, `average`, `summaryStatistics`, `range`; convert with `mapToInt` / `boxed` / `mapToObj`. `IntStream.rangeClosed(1, 5).reduce(1, (a, b) -> a * b)` = `120`.

Gatherers (Java 24, §12.9): `stream.gather(g)` is a custom intermediate operation. Built-ins in `Gatherers`: `windowFixed(2)` on 1..5 → `[[1, 2], [3, 4], [5]]`; `windowSliding(n)`; `scan(() -> 0, Integer::sum)` on 1, 2, 3 → `[1, 3, 6]`; `fold`; `mapConcurrent(n, f)` (runs `f` on virtual threads, keeps order).

Rules and mistakes (§12.7, §12.8, §12.10, §12.11): lambdas in a pipeline should be stateless and must not modify the source; don't use `peek`/`forEach` to fill an outside list — collect instead; `sorted`/`distinct` on infinite streams never finish; close streams from `Files.lines`/`list`/`walk`. Parallel streams pay off only for large, CPU-bound, easily split, stateless work (they use the common `ForkJoinPool`); never for I/O. Loops remain better for early exits with complex state, checked exceptions and index arithmetic.

20.12 I/O and NIO.2

Which API? (§13.1):

Need	Use	Since
Name a file or directory	`Path.of("dir", "a.txt")` (was `Paths.get`)	7 (`Path.of` 11)
Small text file in one call	`Files.readString(p)`, `Files.writeString(p, s)`	11
Lines of a small file	`Files.readAllLines(p)`, `Files.write(p, lines)`	7
Huge text file	`try (Stream<String> s = Files.lines(p))` or `Files.newBufferedReader(p)`	8 / 7
Raw bytes from anywhere	`InputStream` / `OutputStream` (+ `transferTo`, `readAllBytes`)	1.0 (9)
Text from anywhere	`Reader` / `Writer` with an explicit charset	1.1
Big files, random access, memory mapping	`FileChannel` + `ByteBuffer`	1.4
Legacy code that wants `File`	`path.toFile()`, `file.toPath()`	7

`Path` (§13.2) never touches the disk: `Path.of("/a/b/../c/./d.txt").normalize()` → `/a/c/d.txt`; `Path.of("/a/b").relativize(Path.of("/a/c/d"))` → `../c/d`; `Path.of("/a").resolve("b.txt")` → `/a/b.txt`; `getFileName`, `getParent`, `getRoot`, `toAbsolutePath`, `startsWith`.

`Files` (§13.3, §13.4): `exists`, `isDirectory`, `createDirectories` (no error if present), `createFile` (fails if the file exists — `FileAlreadyExistsException`), `createTempFile`/`createTempDirectory`, `copy`/`move` (add `REPLACE_EXISTING`, `ATOMIC_MOVE`), `delete` (throws if missing or a non-empty directory) / `deleteIfExists`, `size`, `mismatch` (12), `list` / `walk` / `find` (lazy `Stream<Path>` — **close them**). `Files.size` counts **bytes**: `"üni\n"` is 6 bytes in UTF-8.

Streams and decorators (§13.5, §13.6): byte streams (`InputStream`/`OutputStream`) vs character streams (`Reader`/`Writer`); bridge with `InputStreamReader`/`OutputStreamWriter` and a charset; wrap in `BufferedReader`/`BufferedWriter`/`BufferedInputStream` (8 KB buffer by default) — unbuffered byte-at-a-time I/O is very slow, and a writer you forget to `flush`/`close` loses data. Always use try-with-resources.

Charsets (§13.7): the default charset is **UTF-8** since Java 18 (`Charset.defaultCharset()`); still pass `StandardCharsets.UTF_8` explicitly for files other systems produce. Mojibake = bytes decoded with the wrong charset.

Binary data (§13.9): `DataInputStream`/`DataOutputStream` for primitives; `FileChannel`, `ByteBuffer` (`flip` before reading what you wrote), memory-mapped files; `WatchService` for directory change events.

Serialization (§13.10): `implements Serializable`, `transient` fields are skipped, declare `serialVersionUID`. Deserialising untrusted data is a **security risk** (gadget chains) — prefer JSON or protobuf; if you must, use deserialization filters (`ObjectInputFilter`, 9; context-specific filters, 17).

Also (§13.8, §13.11–§13.13): `Properties` for `key=value` config (`load`, `getProperty(k, default)`); JSON needs a library (Jackson, Gson) — the JDK has none; `System.in`/`out`/`err`, `Console`, `Scanner`, `IO` (25).

20.13 Concurrency

Threads (§14.1–§14.4):

```
Thread t = Thread.ofPlatform().name("worker").start(task);      // or new Thread(task).start()
Thread v = Thread.ofVirtual().start(task);                      // Java 21
t.join();                                                       // wait for it to finish
```

Call `start()`, not `run()` (which runs on the *current* thread). States: `NEW` → `RUNNABLE` → (`BLOCKED` on a monitor · `WAITING` on `wait`/`join`/`park` · `TIMED_WAITING` on `sleep`/timeouts) → `TERMINATED`. Interruption is cooperative: `t.interrupt()` sets a flag; blocking methods throw `InterruptedException` — rethrow it or restore the flag with `Thread.currentThread().interrupt()`, never swallow it. There is no safe way to kill a thread: `Thread.stop()` threw `UnsupportedOperationException` from Java 20 and was removed in JDK 26. The JVM exits when only daemon threads remain.

The primitives (§14.5–§14.13):

Tool	Gives you	Use for	Remember
`synchronized` (method or block)	mutual exclusion **and** visibility; reentrant	protecting shared mutable state, multi-variable invariants	instance method locks `this`, static method locks the `Class` object; released automatically
`volatile` field	visibility and ordering only	a stop flag, safely publishing a reference	`count++` on a volatile is **still a race**
`AtomicInteger`, `AtomicLong`, `AtomicReference`	lock-free single-variable updates via CAS	counters, sequence numbers	`compareAndSet(expected, new)` → `true` only if the value matched; `LongAdder` for very hot counters
`ReentrantLock`	`tryLock`, timeouts, interruptible, fair mode, several `Condition`s	when `synchronized` isn't flexible enough	**`unlock()` in `finally`**
`ReadWriteLock` / `StampedLock`	many readers or one writer / optimistic reads	read-mostly data	`StampedLock` is not reentrant
`wait` / `notifyAll`	guarded blocks	legacy code — prefer `java.util.concurrent`	call in a `while` loop, holding the lock
`ConcurrentHashMap`	thread-safe map with atomic `merge`, `compute`, `computeIfAbsent`, `putIfAbsent`	shared caches, counters	no `null` keys/values; iterators weakly consistent
`CopyOnWriteArrayList`	snapshot iteration, never throws CME	listeners, read-mostly lists	every write copies the array
`BlockingQueue` (`ArrayBlockingQueue`, `LinkedBlockingQueue`)	`put` waits when full, `take` waits when empty	producer–consumer	prefer bounded queues
`CountDownLatch(n)`	wait until n `countDown()` calls	start/finish gates	one-shot
`CyclicBarrier(n)`	n threads wait for each other, repeatedly	phased algorithms	reusable
`Semaphore(k)`	at most k holders at a time	limit concurrent DB/API calls (also with virtual threads)	`release` in `finally`
`ThreadLocal` / `ScopedValue` (25)	per-thread value / immutable per-call context	request context	remove `ThreadLocal`s on pooled threads

Executors (§14.11): `try (ExecutorService pool = Executors.newFixedThreadPool(n)) { Future<T> f = pool.submit(callable); }` — `ExecutorService` is `AutoCloseable` since Java 19, and `close()` waits for submitted tasks. Factories: `newFixedThreadPool(n)` (unbounded queue!), `newCachedThreadPool()` (unbounded threads!), `newSingleThreadExecutor()`, `newScheduledThreadPool(n)`, `newWorkStealingPool()`, `newVirtualThreadPerTaskExecutor()` (21). For full control use `new ThreadPoolExecutor(core, max, keepAlive, unit, boundedQueue, factory, rejectionPolicy)`. Size CPU-bound pools ≈ number of cores.

`CompletableFuture` (§15.1, §15.2):

Method	Does	Checked result
`supplyAsync(supplier[, executor])` / `runAsync`	start async work (default: common `ForkJoinPool`)	
`thenApply(fn)`	transform (like `map`)	
`thenCompose(fn)`	chain another async step (like `flatMap`)	`5` → `6`
`thenCombine(other, fn)`	combine two independent results	price 20 × qty 3 = `60`
`allOf(…)` / `anyOf(…)`	wait for all / the first	
`exceptionally(fn)`	recover on failure	`-1`
`handle((v, ex) -> …)` / `whenComplete`	always runs; can change result / can't	
`orTimeout(d, unit)` / `completeOnTimeout(v, d, unit)` (9)	time limits	
`join()` / `get()`	block for the result	`join` wraps failures in `CompletionException` (unchecked); `get` in `ExecutionException` (checked)

Virtual threads (Java 21, §15.4, §15.5): cheap threads scheduled by the JVM onto a few carrier (platform) threads; blocking I/O unmounts them. Use one per task (`newVirtualThreadPerTaskExecutor()`) for **I/O-bound**, high-concurrency work; they don't speed up CPU-bound work. Don't pool them; cap scarce resources with a `Semaphore`; avoid big `ThreadLocal` caches. They are always daemon threads. Since **Java 24** (JEP 491) blocking inside `synchronized` no longer pins the carrier; native calls that call back into blocking Java code, and class initialisation, still do.

Also modern (§15.3, §15.6, §15.7): Fork/Join (`RecursiveTask`, work stealing — used by parallel streams); **scoped values** are final in Java 25 (`ScopedValue.where(USER, "alice").call(() -> USER.get())` → `"alice"`, and unbound again afterwards); **structured concurrency** (`StructuredTaskScope.open()` plus a `Joiner` policy) is still **preview** in 25 (JEP 505) and kept changing in 26 (JEP 525) and 27 (JEP 533: built-in joiners make `join()` throw `ExecutionException`, `awaitAll()` removed) — don't write production code against it yet.

Java Memory Model (§15.8): without a *happens-before* edge another thread may never see your write. Edges: program order in one thread; unlock → later lock of the same monitor; volatile write → later read of that field; `Thread.start()` → actions in the thread; actions in a thread → a successful `join()`; `java.util.concurrent` hand-offs (queue put → take, `countDown` → `await`, task submit → run, task → `Future.get`); transitivity. Safe publication: `final` fields, volatile, locks, concurrent collections, static initialisers.

Liveness (§15.9): **deadlock** (threads wait for each other's locks forever — fix with one global lock order, `tryLock` with timeout, fewer locks; diagnose with `jstack`/`jcmd Thread.print`), **livelock** (threads keep reacting to each other without progress — add randomised back-off), **starvation** (a thread never gets CPU or a lock — fair locks, bounded work).

Choosing a model (§15.10): blocking I/O at scale → virtual threads; fan-out/fan-in with composition → `CompletableFuture` (structured concurrency once final); CPU-heavy data work → parallel streams / Fork/Join / fixed pool of ≈ cores; periodic jobs → `ScheduledExecutorService`; shared counters/caches → atomics, `LongAdder`, `ConcurrentHashMap`. For design-level concurrency case studies see the LLD handbook.

20.14 The JVM: memory, GC, flags and tools

How code runs (§1.6, §1.7, §16.1, §16.2, §16.8): `javac` → bytecode in `.class` files → class loaders load classes lazily (bootstrap → platform → application, **parent-first delegation**) → verify, prepare, resolve, initialise (static initialisers run once) → the interpreter runs bytecode; hot methods are compiled by the tiered JIT (**C1** fast, then **C2** heavily optimising: inlining, devirtualisation, escape analysis, loop optimisations, deoptimisation when assumptions break). Hence "warm-up". Class loaders in the checks: `String.class.getClassLoader()` is `null` (bootstrap), `java.sql` classes use the `platform` loader, your classes the `app` loader.

Memory areas (§16.3, §1.8):

Area	Per thread?	Holds	Size flag	When it runs out
Heap (young: eden + survivors; old)	shared	all objects and arrays	`-Xms`, `-Xmx`, `-XX:MaxRAMPercentage`	`OutOfMemoryError: Java heap space`
Java stack	per thread	frames: locals, operand stack	`-Xss`	`StackOverflowError`
Metaspace (native memory; replaced PermGen in 8)	shared	class metadata	`-XX:MaxMetaspaceSize` (unlimited by default)	`OutOfMemoryError: Metaspace`
Code cache	shared	JIT-compiled code	`-XX:ReservedCodeCacheSize`	JIT stops compiling (slow, not a crash)
Direct / native memory	shared	direct `ByteBuffer`s, thread stacks, GC structures	`-XX:MaxDirectMemorySize`	`OutOfMemoryError: Direct buffer memory` / `unable to create native thread`

Object size basics (§16.4): 12-byte header (8 with `-XX:+UseCompactObjectHeaders`, Java 25; the default from JDK 27), 4-byte compressed references, padded to 8 bytes — `new Object()` is 16 bytes; `record Point(int x, int y)` 24.

Garbage collectors (§16.5–§16.7) — an object is garbage when it isn't reachable from GC roots (thread stacks, static fields, JNI handles):

Collector	Flag	Pauses	Choose it for
G1 (default since 9 on machines with ≥ 2 CPUs and ≥ 1792 MB; in all environments from JDK 27, JEP 523)	`-XX:+UseG1GC`	goal `-XX:MaxGCPauseMillis` (200 ms default); typically a few–tens of ms	most services — the default for a reason
Parallel	`-XX:+UseParallelGC`	longer, grows with live data	batch jobs: maximum throughput
Serial	`-XX:+UseSerialGC`	stop-the-world, single thread	tiny heaps, 1 CPU, CLI tools (before JDK 27 the JVM picked it on machines with < 2 CPUs or < 1792 MB)
ZGC (generational; generational-only since 24)	`-XX:+UseZGC`	typically < 1 ms, independent of heap size	latency-sensitive services, huge heaps
Shenandoah (generational mode product in 25)	`-XX:+UseShenandoahGC`	sub-ms to a few ms	low latency; in most OpenJDK builds, not Oracle's
Epsilon	`-XX:+UnlockExperimentalVMOptions -XX:+UseEpsilonGC`	none — never collects	benchmarks, ultra-short jobs

Key flags (§16.7):

Flag	Meaning
`-Xms512m -Xmx2g`	initial / maximum heap (set them equal for servers to avoid resizing)
`-XX:MaxRAMPercentage=75`	heap as % of container memory (default 25)
`-Xss1m`	thread stack size (default platform-dependent: about 1 MB on 64-bit Linux, 2 MB on macOS/AArch64)
`-Xlog:gc*` (or `-Xlog:gc:file=gc.log`)	unified GC logging (9+)
`-XX:+HeapDumpOnOutOfMemoryError -XX:HeapDumpPath=/dumps`	heap dump on OOM
`-XX:+PrintFlagsFinal`	print every flag's final value
`-XX:StartFlightRecording=duration=60s,filename=app.jfr`	record with JDK Flight Recorder at start-up
`-XX:TieredStopAtLevel=1`	C1 only: faster start-up, lower peak speed
`-ea`	enable `assert` statements
`--enable-preview`	allow preview features (needs `--release N` at compile time)
`-XX:+UseCompactObjectHeaders`	8-byte object headers (25, opt-in; on by default from JDK 27, JEP 534)

Diagnostic tools (§16.10, §16.11):

Tool	Use
`jps -l`	list running JVMs and PIDs
`jcmd <pid> help`	the Swiss-army knife: `VM.flags`, `GC.heap_info`, `GC.class_histogram`, `Thread.print`, `GC.heap_dump file.hprof`, `JFR.start` / `JFR.dump`, `VM.native_memory`
`jstat -gcutil <pid> 1000`	heap occupancy and GC counts every second
`jstack <pid>`	thread dump — look for `BLOCKED` and "Found one Java-level deadlock"
JFR + `jfr view hot-methods app.jfr` / JDK Mission Control	low-overhead production profiling
VisualVM, Eclipse MAT, async-profiler	GUI monitoring, heap-dump analysis (dominator tree), flame graphs
JMH	micro-benchmarks that avoid warm-up and dead-code traps (§16.9)
`jdeps`, `jlink`	module dependencies / build a trimmed runtime (§16.12)

Symptom → first tool: high CPU → JFR hot methods; latency spikes → GC log pauses; hangs → two or three thread dumps; memory growth → `jstat` old-gen trend + class histogram twice, then a heap dump; RSS far above heap → native memory tracking. Classic leaks: unbounded static caches, unregistered listeners, `ThreadLocal`s on pooled threads, mutated `HashMap` keys, class-loader leaks.

Modules (JPMS) (§16.12): `module-info.java` with `requires`, `exports`, `opens` (for reflection), `uses`/`provides` (services); the class path is the *unnamed module*; `import module java.base;` (25) imports every exported package of a module.

20.15 Modern Java by version: 17 to 25

Final features only — the version that **finalised** each one (§17.2; JEP numbers in parentheses). The book's baseline before 17: `var` (10), `HttpClient` and `java Hello.java` (11), switch expressions and helpful NPE messages (14; the messages on by default since 15), text blocks (15), records, `instanceof` patterns and `Stream.toList()` (16).

Release	GA	Language and libraries	JVM and tools
17 LTS	Sep 2021	sealed classes (409), enhanced pseudo-random generators (356), always-strict floating point (306), context-specific deserialization filters (415)	strong encapsulation of JDK internals (403), macOS/AArch64 port (391)
18	Mar 2022	UTF-8 by default (400), `@snippet` in Javadoc (413)	simple web server `jwebserver` (408); finalization deprecated for removal (421)
19, 20	Sep 2022, Mar 2023	previews and incubators only	Linux/RISC-V port (422, in 19)
21 LTS	Sep 2023	record patterns (440), pattern matching for `switch` (441), **virtual threads** (444), sequenced collections (431), key encapsulation mechanism API (452)	generational ZGC (439), warnings for dynamically loaded agents (451)
22	Mar 2024	unnamed variables and patterns `_` (456), Foreign Function & Memory API (454), multi-file source launch (458)	region pinning for G1 (423)
23	Sep 2024	Markdown documentation comments `///` (467)	ZGC generational by default (474); `sun.misc.Unsafe` memory access deprecated for removal (471)
24	Mar 2025	**stream gatherers** (485), Class-File API (484), ML-KEM (496) and ML-DSA (497) post-quantum crypto	virtual threads without `synchronized` pinning (491), AOT class loading and linking (483), non-generational ZGC removed (490), Security Manager permanently disabled (486)
25 LTS	Sep 2025	compact source files and instance `main` (512), module import declarations (511), flexible constructor bodies (513), **scoped values** (506), key derivation function API (510)	compact object headers (519, opt-in), generational Shenandoah (521), AOT ergonomics (514) and method profiling (515), JFR cooperative sampling (518) and method timing (520)

Still not final in Java 25 (§17.11): structured concurrency (fifth preview, 505; sixth in 26, seventh in 27), primitive types in patterns (third preview, 507), stable values (preview, 502; renamed *lazy constants* in 26), PEM encodings (preview, 470), Vector API (tenth incubator, 508), JFR CPU-time profiling (experimental, 509). **Withdrawn**: string templates (previewed in 21 and 22, removed in 23). Try a preview with `javac --release 25 --enable-preview` and `java --enable-preview`. After 25 (§17.11): JDK 26 (Mar 2026) finalised HTTP/3 in `HttpClient` (517) and removed the Applet API (504) and `Thread.stop`; JDK 27 (Sep 2026) made G1 the default everywhere (523) and compact object headers the default (534). LTS releases: 8, 11, 17, 21, 25 (every two years); the next is expected to be 29 in September 2027 (§1.12).

Upgrading 17 → 25 (§17.12): raise the JDK first and `--release` second; upgrade build plugins and bytecode libraries (Lombok, Mockito, Byte Buddy, Spring); run `jdeps --jdk-internals` and `jdeprscan`; read the start-up warnings (agents, JNI, `Unsafe`); drop removed flags such as `-XX:-ZGenerational`.

20.16 Testing, build and tooling commands

JDK tools (§1.4–§1.11, §18.12, §18.13):

Command	Does
`java -version`, `javac -version`	check the installed JDK
`javac --release 25 -d out $(find src -name '*.java')`	compile for a target Java version
`java -cp out:lib/* com.example.Main`	run with a class path (`;` on Windows)
`jar --create --file app.jar --main-class com.example.Main -C out .`	build an executable JAR; run with `java -jar app.jar`
`javadoc -d docs …`, `javap -c`, `jshell`	docs, bytecode, REPL
`jlink`, `jpackage`	custom runtime image / native installer
`bash tools_run_java.sh java`	this book's runner: compiles each chapter's `code/` with `--release 25` and runs every `main`

Maven (§18.2; this book: Maven 3.9.14, Gradle 9.4.1) — `pom.xml`; coordinates `groupId:artifactId:version`; scopes `compile`, `test`, `provided`, `runtime`; "nearest wins" for version conflicts (pin with `dependencyManagement`); pin every plugin version too. Lifecycle: `validate → compile → test-compile → test → package → verify → install → deploy` — running a phase runs every phase before it.

Command	Does
`mvn clean verify`	full build with all checks (what CI runs)
`mvn test`, `mvn -Dtest=CartTest test`	run all / one test class (`CartTest#method` for one method)
`mvn package -DskipTests`	build the JAR without running tests
`mvn dependency:tree`	print the resolved dependency tree
`./mvnw …`	the Maven Wrapper: pinned Maven version, committed to the repo

Gradle (§18.3) — `build.gradle(.kts)`; configurations `implementation`, `testImplementation`, `runtimeOnly`; incremental and cached tasks.

Command	Does
`./gradlew build`	compile, test, assemble
`./gradlew test --tests 'ch18.shop.CartTest'`	run matching tests
`./gradlew run`	run the `application` plugin's main class
`./gradlew dependencies --configuration testRuntimeClasspath`, `./gradlew tasks`	inspect

JUnit Jupiter (§18.4, §18.5, §18.8) — the same API in JUnit 5 and JUnit 6 (6.0, 2025: Java 17 baseline, one version number for Platform/Jupiter/Vintage, JSpecify annotations, Vintage deprecated); this book ran JUnit 6.1.3:

Annotation	Meaning
`@Test`	a test method (package-private is fine)
`@BeforeEach` / `@AfterEach`	run around every test (a new test-class instance per test by default)
`@BeforeAll` / `@AfterAll`	once per class (`static`)
`@DisplayName`, `@Disabled`, `@Tag`, `@Timeout`, `@Nested`	naming, skipping, filtering, time limit, grouping
`@ParameterizedTest` + `@ValueSource`, `@CsvSource`, `@MethodSource`, `@EnumSource`, `@NullAndEmptySource`	one test, many inputs
`@TempDir Path dir`	fresh temporary directory
`@ExtendWith(MockitoExtension.class)`	plug in an extension

Assertions: `assertEquals(expected, actual)` (expected first), `assertTrue`, `assertNull`, `assertThrows(X.class, () -> …)` (returns the exception), `assertAll(…)` (report every failure), `assertIterableEquals`, `assertTimeout`. Console launcher: `java -jar junit-platform-console-standalone-<version>.jar execute --class-path out:libs --scan-class-path`.

Mockito (§18.6): `mock(Repo.class)` or `@Mock`; stub with `when(repo.find("a")).thenReturn(Optional.of(x))` / `thenThrow`; `verify(repo).save(any())`, `verify(repo, never()).delete(…)`, `times(2)`; `ArgumentCaptor`; `@InjectMocks`; stub only what the test needs (strict stubs flag the rest). Fakes beat mocks for simple collaborators. Mockito 5 (this book: 5.24.0) mocks `final` classes through an agent — on JDK 21+ add `-javaagent:mockito-core.jar` to the test JVM (Surefire `argLine`, Gradle `jvmArgs`) instead of letting it self-attach.

AssertJ (§18.7): `assertThat(list).hasSize(3).containsExactly("a", "b", "c")`; `assertThat(s).startsWith("J").contains("av")`; `assertThatThrownBy(() -> …).isInstanceOf(IllegalArgumentException.class).hasMessageContaining("negative")`; `extracting(Order::id)`; `usingRecursiveComparison()`.

Test design (§18.9): Arrange–Act–Assert; one behaviour per test; name tests after behaviour; FIRST (fast, independent, repeatable, self-validating, timely); inject clocks and random seeds; test pyramid (many unit, some integration — Testcontainers — few end-to-end).

Logging (§18.10): code against SLF4J (`private static final Logger log = LoggerFactory.getLogger(Foo.class); log.info("order {} placed", id);` — placeholders, not concatenation), with Logback or Log4j 2 as the backend; levels `TRACE < DEBUG < INFO < WARN < ERROR`; `java.util.logging` is built in (`FINE`, `INFO`, `WARNING`, `SEVERE`). Pass the exception as the last argument to keep the stack trace.

JDBC (§18.11): `try (Connection c = dataSource.getConnection(); PreparedStatement ps = c.prepareStatement("SELECT … WHERE id = ?")) { ps.setLong(1, id); try (ResultSet rs = ps.executeQuery()) { while (rs.next()) … } }` — always `PreparedStatement` (prevents SQL injection), a connection pool (HikariCP) in real apps, `setAutoCommit(false)` + `commit`/`rollback` for transactions. SQL itself: the SQL handbook.

20.17 Interview question index

All 42 questions are answered in Chapter 19 §19.29, each with links back to the teaching section; claims marked ✔ there are proven by a runnable program. The coding side — the Java DSA toolkit (§19.1–§19.7) and twenty patterns from two pointers to math and geometry (§19.8–§19.27) — is in the same chapter. Pattern finder:

Problem says…	Pattern	Section
sorted input, pair with target sum, in place	two pointers	§19.8
longest/shortest contiguous substring or subarray	sliding window	§19.9
seen before, count, group, pair in unsorted data	hashing	§19.10
range sums, subarrays summing to k (negatives allowed)	prefix sums	§19.11
brackets, next greater element	stack / monotonic stack	§19.12
k largest, merge k lists, running median, best among currently eligible	heap, two heaps	§19.13
sorted, first true, minimum capacity such that	binary search (on the answer)	§19.14
meetings, overlaps, rooms	intervals	§19.15
fewest steps, islands, weighted route	BFS / DFS / Dijkstra	§19.16
prerequisites, order with dependencies	topological sort	§19.17
connected groups as edges arrive	union-find	§19.18
number of ways, min cost, longest subsequence	dynamic programming	§19.19
all subsets, permutations, N-Queens	backtracking	§19.20
many prefix queries, autocomplete	trie	§19.21
k-th from end, middle, cycle start, intersection, palindrome list	linked lists, fast/slow pointers	§19.22
validate BST, lowest common ancestor, path sum, serialise	tree recursion (top-down / bottom-up)	§19.23
jump game, gas station, candies, local best is safe	greedy	§19.24
k-th element without full sort, sort colours, sort a list	quickselect, Dutch flag, merge sort	§19.25
appears twice except one, count 1-bits, subsets of ≤ 20	bit manipulation	§19.26
spiral matrix, reverse digits, points on a line, Josephus	math and geometry	§19.27

Strings, objects and the language → §19.29

Q	Topic	Q	Topic
1	why `String` is immutable	7	`final` vs `finally` vs `finalize`
2	the string pool; objects made by `new String("hi")`	8	making a class immutable
3	`String` vs `StringBuilder` vs `StringBuffer`	9	interface vs abstract class
4	the `equals`/`hashCode` contract	10	records and their limits
5	`==` vs `equals`, the `Integer` cache	11	sealed classes
6	pass-by-value	12	overloading vs overriding

Collections → §19.29: Q13 `HashMap` internals · Q14 mutating a key · Q15 `HashMap` vs `Hashtable` vs `synchronizedMap` vs `ConcurrentHashMap` · Q16 how `ConcurrentHashMap` is thread-safe · Q17 `ArrayList` vs `LinkedList` · Q18 map orderings and an LRU cache · Q19 `Comparable` vs `Comparator` · Q20 fail-fast vs weakly consistent iterators · Q21 `ArrayDeque` vs `Stack` · Q22 `List.of` vs `Arrays.asList` vs `unmodifiableList`.

Exceptions → §19.29: Q23 checked vs unchecked · Q24 how try-with-resources works · Q25 when `finally` doesn't run.

Generics, lambdas and streams → **§19.29**: Q26 type erasure and its limits · Q27 PECS · Q28 streams vs loops · Q29 misusing `Optional` · Q30 functional interfaces and effectively final.

Concurrency → **§19.29**: Q31 `volatile` vs `synchronized` · Q32 happens-before · Q33 deadlock · Q34 virtual threads · Q35 `Runnable`/`Callable`, `Future`/`CompletableFuture` · Q36 why executors.

The JVM → **§19.29**: Q37 memory areas · Q38 GC and the default collector · Q39 memory leaks · Q40 class loading, interpreter and JIT · Q41 `static` and static initialisers · Q42 modern Java features to use in interviews.

More interview material: each chapter's **In the interview** sections, the modern-Java round in §17.13, and exam-level traps in the OCP Java 21 study notes.

20.18 Where next

You now know the language, the core library, the JVM and the tools. What to learn next depends on the job you want:

Direction	What it is	First step
Spring Boot	the dominant framework for Java back-ends (Boot 4.0, Nov 2025, on Spring Framework 7; 4.1 in 2026; Java 17+): dependency injection, auto-configuration, starters for web, data, security, and Actuator for operations (§18.14)	generate a project at start.spring.io, build a small REST API with JDBC or JPA, test it with JUnit, Mockito and Testcontainers
Jakarta EE (formerly Java EE)	the standard enterprise specifications — Servlet, CDI, JPA, JAX-RS (Jakarta REST), Bean Validation — implemented by WildFly, Open Liberty, Payara	learn JPA and CDI; much of Spring uses the same specifications (e.g. JPA via Hibernate)
Quarkus, Micronaut, Helidon	cloud-native frameworks with fast start-up and small memory, strong GraalVM native-image support	port your Spring REST API to compare
Kotlin	a JetBrains language on the JVM, fully interoperable with Java: null-safe types, data classes, coroutines; Google's preferred language for Android since 2019	rewrite one small program; call it from Java
Other JVM languages	Scala (functional + OO, Spark), Groovy (Gradle scripts, scripting), Clojure (Lisp)	only if a job needs them
Android	mobile apps with the Android SDK (Kotlin-first today, Java supported)	Android Developers' basic course
Data and messaging	JDBC/JPA, Kafka clients, Spark, Flink	the SQL handbook and the DDIA notes
Design	SOLID, patterns, low-level design case studies in Java	the LLD handbook
Certification	Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 21 Developer (1Z0-830)	the OCP Java 21 study notes
Performance	JFR, JMH, GC tuning, async-profiler	revisit Chapter 16 with a real service

Keep up to date by reading the JEP list for each release on openjdk.org and the dev.java articles; a new feature release ships every March and September.

20.19 Glossary (A–Z)

Each term has a short definition and a link to the section that teaches it. Backticks and symbols are ignored when sorting; *italic* names point to another entry. 344 terms.

A

- **Abstract class** — A class declared `abstract` that can't be instantiated; it may hold state, constructors and abstract methods for subclasses to implement. §6.5
- **Abstract method** — A method with no body that a concrete subclass (or implementing class) must implement. §6.5
- **Access modifier** — `private`, package-private (none), `protected` or `public` — controls where a member can be used. §5.6
- **Accessor (record)** — The generated method named like a record component, e.g. `x()` for `record Point(int x, int y)`. §6.8
- **Actuator** — The Spring Boot module that exposes health, metrics and info endpoints for operations. §18.14
- **Amortised O(1)** — Constant cost on average over many calls, even if an occasional call (such as an `ArrayList` resize) is O(n). §10.12
- **Annotation** — Metadata written `@Name` on code (`@Override`, `@FunctionalInterface`, `@Test`) that the compiler, tools or frameworks read. §6.3, §18.4
- **Anonymous class** — A class declared and instantiated in one expression, `new Interface() { … }`, with no name. §6.11
- **AOT cache** — Ahead-of-time class loading and linking data (Java 24–25) that the JVM reuses to start faster. §17.9, §17.10
- `ArithmeticException` — Unchecked exception for integer division by zero or overflow detected by `Math.*Exact` methods. §2.10, §7.5
- **Array** — A fixed-length, indexed, zero-based container of one element type; an object with a `length` field. §4.6
- `ArrayDeque` — A resizable circular-array `Deque`; the recommended stack and queue; rejects `null`. §10.6
- `ArrayIndexOutOfBoundsException` — Thrown when an array index is negative or ≥ `length`. §4.6
- `ArrayList` — A growable-array `List` with O(1) indexed access and amortised O(1) append; the default list. §10.2
- `Arrays.asList` — Returns a fixed-size `List` view backed by an array: `set` writes through, `add`/`remove` throw. §4.8, §10.10
- `assert` — A statement that checks a condition only when the JVM runs with `-ea`; disabled by default. §19.1
- **AssertJ** — A fluent assertion library: `assertThat(x).isEqualTo(y)`. §18.7
- **Associativity** — The grouping order for operators of equal precedence — left for most, right for assignment and the ternary. §2.9
- **Atomic variable** — A class such as `AtomicInteger` whose single-variable updates are atomic without locks, using CAS. §14.10
- **Autoboxing** — Automatic conversion from a primitive to its wrapper (`int` → `Integer`); unboxing is the reverse. §7.6
- `AutoCloseable` — The interface with `close()` that try-with-resources calls automatically. §8.6

B

- **Backing array** — The array behind an `ArrayList` or an `Arrays.asList` view. §10.2, §10.10
- `BigDecimal` — Immutable arbitrary-precision decimal number with an explicit scale; used for money. §7.7
- `BigInteger` — Immutable arbitrary-size integer. §7.7

- **Big-O notation** — How an operation's cost grows with input size n: O(1), O(log n), O(n), O(n log n), O(n²). §10.12, §19.7
- **Binary search** — Finding a key in sorted data by halving the range each step, O(log n). §4.8, §19.14
- **Bitwise operators** — `&`, `\|`, `^`, `~`, `<<`, `>>`, `>>>` — operate on the individual bits of integers. §2.8
- `BLOCKED` — The thread state of a thread waiting to acquire a monitor held by another thread. §14.3
- `BlockingQueue` — A queue whose `put` waits when full and `take` waits when empty; the core of producer–consumer. §14.12
- **Bootstrap class loader** — The JVM's built-in loader for core modules such as `java.base`; shown as `null` by `getClassLoader()`. §16.2
- **Bounded type parameter** — A type parameter with a limit, e.g. `<T extends Number>`. §9.5
- **Boxing** — Wrapping a primitive value in its wrapper object. §7.6
- `break` — Leaves the innermost loop or `switch` (or a labelled statement with `break label`). §3.9
- **Bucket** — One slot of a hash table's array, holding the entries whose hashes map to that index. §10.5
- **Buffering** — Reading or writing data in blocks through an in-memory buffer to avoid many slow system calls. §13.6
- **Build tool** — Software (Maven, Gradle) that resolves dependencies, compiles, tests and packages a project. §18.2, §18.3
- **Byte stream** — `InputStream`/`OutputStream`: I/O in raw 8-bit bytes. §13.5
- `ByteBuffer` — A NIO container of bytes with position, limit and capacity, used with channels. §13.9
- **Bytecode** — The platform-independent instruction set in `.class` files that the JVM executes. §1.6

C

- **C1 / C2** — HotSpot's two JIT compilers: C1 compiles quickly with light optimisation, C2 slowly with heavy optimisation. §1.7, §16.8
- `Callable` — A task interface `V call() throws Exception` that returns a value; see `Runnable`. §14.11
- **Carrier thread** — A platform thread on which the JVM mounts virtual threads to run them. §15.4
- **CAS (compare-and-set)** — An atomic CPU instruction that updates a value only if it still equals an expected value. §14.10
- **Casting** — Explicit conversion `(Type) value` — narrowing a primitive, or checking an object's run-time type. §2.7, §6.4
- `char` — The 16-bit unsigned primitive holding one UTF-16 code unit (0 … 65 535). §2.3
- **Character stream** — `Reader`/`Writer`: I/O in 16-bit characters, decoded with a charset. §13.5
- **Charset** — A mapping between characters and bytes, such as UTF-8; the JDK default since Java 18 is UTF-8. §13.7
- **Checked exception** — An `Exception` outside the `RuntimeException` branch; must be caught or declared with `throws`. §8.2, §8.3
- **Class** — A blueprint that defines fields, constructors and methods; objects are its instances. §5.1
- **Class file** — The `.class` file `javac` produces, containing bytecode and a constant pool. §1.6
- **Class initialisation** — Running a class's static field initialisers and `static {}` blocks, once, on first active use. §5.10, §16.2
- **Class loader** — The object that finds and loads class bytes; loaders delegate to their parent first. §16.2
- **Class path** — The list of directories and JARs where the JVM looks for classes (`-cp`). §1.5
- **Class-File API** — The `java.lang.classfile` API (final in Java 24) for reading and writing class files. §17.9
- **Closure** — A function together with the variables it captured from its surrounding scope; lambdas capture effectively final locals. §11.5
- **Code cache** — Memory where the JIT stores compiled machine code. §16.3
- **Collection** — The root interface of lists, sets and queues (maps are separate). §10.1

- **`Collections`** — Utility class with `sort`, `reverse`, `shuffle`, `frequency`, `unmodifiableList` and more. §10.9
- **Collector** — A recipe for accumulating stream elements into a result, e.g. `groupingBy`, `toMap`, `joining`. §12.5
- **Compact constructor** — A record constructor without a parameter list, used to validate or normalise components. §6.8
- **Compact object headers** — Java 25 option (`-XX:+UseCompactObjectHeaders`) that shrinks object headers from 12 to 8 bytes; on by default from JDK 27. §16.4, §17.10
- **Compact source file** — A Java 25 source file with top-level methods and no class declaration; run with `java File.java`. §4.9, §17.10
- **`Comparable`** — Interface whose `compareTo` defines a class's natural order. §10.8
- **`Comparator`** — A separate object whose `compare` defines an ordering; built with `comparing`, `thenComparing`, `reversed`. §10.8
- **Compile-time constant** — A `final` primitive or `String` initialised with a constant expression; folded by `javac`. §7.1
- **`CompletableFuture`** — A `Future` you can complete manually and compose asynchronously (`thenApply`, `thenCompose`, `allOf`). §15.2
- **`CompletionException`** — The unchecked wrapper `CompletableFuture.join()` throws when the computation failed. §15.2
- **Compound assignment** — Operators such as `+=`, which include an implicit cast back to the variable's type. §2.8
- **Concurrency** — Several tasks in progress over the same period, possibly interleaved on one core. §14.1
- **`ConcurrentHashMap`** — A thread-safe, highly scalable hash map with atomic `merge`/`compute`; no `null` keys or values. §14.12
- **`ConcurrentModificationException`** — Thrown by fail-fast iterators when a collection is structurally changed during iteration. §10.7
- **Constructor** — A special method with the class's name that initialises a new object. §5.3
- **Constructor chaining** — Calling another constructor with `this(...)` or the parent's with `super(...)`. §5.3, §6.1
- **Context switch** — The OS pausing one thread and running another on the same CPU core. §14.1
- **`continue`** — Skips to the next iteration of the innermost (or labelled) loop. §3.9
- **`CopyOnWriteArrayList`** — A thread-safe list that copies its array on every write; iterators see a snapshot. §14.12
- **`CountDownLatch`** — A one-shot synchronizer: threads `await()` until `countDown()` has been called n times. §14.13
- **Covariant return type** — An overriding method may return a subtype of the overridden method's return type. §6.3
- **Critical section** — Code that touches shared mutable state and must not run in two threads at once. §14.1
- **`CyclicBarrier`** — A reusable synchronizer where n threads wait for each other before all continue. §14.13

D

- **Daemon thread** — A background thread that doesn't keep the JVM alive; virtual threads are always daemon. §14.2
- **Data race** — Two threads access the same variable without a happens-before order and at least one writes. §15.8
- **`DateTimeFormatter`** — Immutable, thread-safe formatter and parser for `java.time` values. §7.11
- **Deadlock** — Threads wait forever for locks each other holds. §15.9
- **Default method** — An interface method with a body (Java 8), inherited by implementing classes unless overridden. §6.6

- **Default value** — The initial value of a field or array element: `0`, `false` or `null`; local variables have none. §2.2, §2.3
- **Defensive copy** — Copying a mutable input or output so outside code can't change an object's internal state. §5.9
- **Deoptimisation** — The JIT discarding compiled code whose speculative assumptions stopped holding. §16.8
- **Dependency injection** — Supplying an object's collaborators from outside (usually through the constructor) instead of creating them inside. §18.6, §18.14
- `Deque` — A double-ended queue: insert and remove at both ends; used as stack or queue. §10.6
- **Diamond operator** — `<>` in `new HashMap<>()` — lets the compiler infer the type arguments. §9.2
- **Direct memory** — Native memory outside the heap used by direct `ByteBuffer`s. §16.3
- `double` — The 64-bit IEEE 754 floating-point primitive; the default for decimals. §2.3, §2.11
- `do-while` — A loop that runs its body once before testing the condition. §3.8
- `Duration` — A `java.time` amount of time in seconds and nanoseconds (e.g. `PT1H30M`). §7.10
- **Dynamic dispatch** — Choosing which overridden method to run from the object's run-time class. §6.4

E

- **Effectively final** — A local variable that is never reassigned after initialisation; lambdas may capture only these. §11.5
- **Encapsulation** — Hiding an object's state behind methods so its invariants can't be broken from outside. §5.7
- **Enhanced** `for` — The for-each loop, `for (T x : iterable)`. §3.8
- **Enum** — A type with a fixed set of named instances; may have fields, constructors and methods. §6.9
- `EnumMap` / `EnumSet` — Very compact, fast map/set implementations for enum keys/elements. §10.4, §10.3
- **Epsilon GC** — A no-op collector that never frees memory; for testing. §16.5
- `equals` — The method that defines logical equality; must be consistent with `hashCode`. §6.13
- **Erasure** — See *type erasure*. §9.7
- `Error` — The `Throwable` branch for serious JVM problems such as `OutOfMemoryError`; unchecked, normally not caught. §8.2
- **Escape analysis** — A JIT analysis proving an object doesn't leave a method, enabling scalar replacement and lock elision. §16.8
- **Exception** — An object signalling an abnormal condition, thrown with `throw` and caught with `catch`. §8.1
- **Exception chaining** — Wrapping a low-level exception as the cause of a higher-level one. §8.8
- **Exception translation** — Catching an exception at a layer boundary and throwing one that fits the higher layer's abstraction. §8.8
- `ExecutorService` — A thread-pool abstraction that accepts tasks and returns `Future`s; `AutoCloseable` since Java 19. §14.11
- **Exhaustive switch** — A `switch` whose cases cover every possible value (all enum constants, all permitted subtypes, or `default`). §3.3, §3.6
- **Explicit lock** — A `java.util.concurrent.locks.Lock` such as `ReentrantLock`, acquired and released in code. §14.9

F

- **Fail-fast iterator** — An iterator that throws `ConcurrentModificationException` on a best-effort basis when its collection changes structurally. §10.7
- `final` — Modifier: a final variable is assigned once, a final method can't be overridden, a final class can't be extended. §5.8
- **Finalization** — The deprecated-for-removal `finalize()` mechanism (Java 18, JEP 421); use try-with-resources or `Cleaner`. §17.12
- `finally` — A block after `try` that always runs when control leaves the `try`. §8.4

- **Flexible constructor bodies** — Java 25 feature allowing statements that don't use `this` before `super(...)` or `this(...)`. §17.10
- `float` — The 32-bit IEEE 754 floating-point primitive (~7 significant digits). §2.3
- **Floating-point error** — Rounding error because binary fractions can't represent most decimals exactly (`0.1 + 0.2`). §2.11
- **Foreign Function & Memory API** — The `java.lang.foreign` API (final in Java 22) to call native code and manage off-heap memory, replacing JNI. §17.7
- **Fork/Join** — A framework for recursive divide-and-conquer tasks run by a work-stealing `ForkJoinPool`. §15.3
- **Formatter specifier** — A pattern such as `%5.2f` or `%-10s` in `String.format`/`printf`. §7.4
- **Functional interface** — An interface with exactly one abstract method; a lambda or method reference can implement it. §11.2
- `Future` — A handle to an asynchronous result, obtained with a blocking `get()`. §15.1

G

- **Garbage collection (GC)** — Automatic reclamation of memory used by objects that are no longer reachable. §1.8, §16.5
- **Garbage-First (G1)** — The default collector since Java 9 (in all environments from JDK 27); region-based, with a pause-time goal. §16.5
- **Gatherer** — A custom intermediate stream operation used with `stream.gather(...)` (final in Java 24). §12.9
- **GC roots** — Starting points for reachability: thread stacks, static fields, JNI references. §16.5
- **Generational hypothesis** — Most objects die young, so collectors split the heap into young and old generations. §16.5
- **Generic method** — A method that declares its own type parameters: `static <T> T first(List<T> xs)`. §9.4
- **Generics** — Type parameters on classes, interfaces and methods for compile-time type safety without casts. §9.1
- **Gradle** — A build tool using a Groovy or Kotlin DSL with incremental, cached tasks. §18.3
- **Guard (pattern)** — A `when` condition attached to a `case` pattern. §3.6

H

- **Happens-before** — The Java Memory Model relation guaranteeing one action's effects are visible to another. §15.8
- `hashCode` — Returns an `int` used by hash-based collections; equal objects must return equal hash codes. §6.13
- `HashMap` — An unordered hash-table map with average O(1) operations; allows one `null` key. §10.4, §10.5
- `HashSet` — A set backed by a `HashMap`; unordered, average O(1). §10.3
- **Heap** — The JVM memory area where all objects and arrays live, shared by all threads and garbage-collected. §16.3
- **Heap dump** — A snapshot of every object in the heap, analysed with Eclipse MAT or VisualVM. §16.10, §16.11
- **Heap pollution** — A variable of a parameterized type referring to an object of the wrong type, caused by unchecked operations. §9.8
- **Helpful NullPointerException** — NPE messages that name exactly which expression was `null` (Java 14, on by default since 15). §8.1
- **Hiding** — A static method or field in a subclass with the same name as the parent's; chosen by compile-time type, not overridden. §6.2

I

- `IllegalArgumentException` — Unchecked exception for a method argument that violates a precondition. §8.7

- **`IllegalStateException`** — Unchecked exception for a call made when the object is in the wrong state. §8.7
- **Immutable object** — An object whose state can't change after construction, such as `String` or a record of immutable values. §5.9
- **Incubator module** — An experimental API in a `jdk.incubator.*` module, e.g. the Vector API. §17.1
- **Inheritance** — A subclass acquiring a superclass's members with `extends`; Java has single class inheritance. §6.1
- **Initialisation order** — Static initialisers once per class, then for each object: parent constructor, field initialisers and instance blocks, constructor body. §5.10
- **Inlining** — The JIT copying a callee's body into its caller to remove call overhead and enable further optimisation. §16.8
- **Inner class** — A non-static nested class; each instance holds a reference to an enclosing instance. §6.10
- **Instance main method** — A Java 25 `main` that is not `static` and may take no parameters: `void main()`. §4.9, §17.10
- **`instanceof`** — Operator testing an object's run-time type; with a pattern it also binds a variable (Java 16). §3.5
- **`int`** — The 32-bit signed integer primitive, range -2^{31} … $2^{31}-1$. §2.3
- **`Integer` cache** — `Integer.valueOf` returns cached objects for −128 … 127, so `==` happens to work only in that range. §7.6
- **Integer overflow** — A result outside a type's range wraps around silently (`Integer.MAX_VALUE + 1` is `MIN_VALUE`). §2.10
- **Interface** — A contract type: abstract, default, static and private methods plus constants; a class can implement many. §6.6
- **Intermediate operation** — A lazy stream operation such as `filter` or `map` that returns a new stream. §12.3
- **Interning** — Obtaining the pooled copy of a string with `intern()`. §7.1
- **Interpreter** — The JVM component that executes bytecode instruction by instruction before the JIT compiles hot code. §1.7
- **Interruption** — Cooperative cancellation: `interrupt()` sets a flag that blocking methods answer with `InterruptedException`. §14.4
- **`IO` class** — `java.lang.IO` (Java 25): `println`, `print` and `readln` for simple console programs. §4.9, §17.10
- **`Iterable`** — Anything with an `iterator()`; usable in an enhanced `for`. §10.1, §10.7
- **`Iterator`** — An object with `hasNext`, `next` and optional `remove` for walking a collection. §10.7

J

- **Jakarta EE** — The Eclipse Foundation's enterprise Java specifications (formerly Java EE): Servlet, JPA, CDI, REST. §1.2, §18.14
- **JAR** — A ZIP archive of class files and resources with a manifest; executable with `java -jar` when it names a `Main-Class`. §18.12
- **Java Memory Model (JMM)** — The rules defining when writes by one thread become visible to others. §15.8
- **`javac`** — The Java compiler; turns `.java` source into `.class` bytecode. §1.5
- **`java.time`** — The modern date-time API (Java 8): immutable, thread-safe classes such as `LocalDate` and `Instant`. §7.8
- **`jcmd`** — The command-line tool that sends diagnostic commands to a running JVM. §16.10
- **JDBC** — The standard API for talking to relational databases: `Connection`, `PreparedStatement`, `ResultSet`. §18.11
- **JDK** — Java Development Kit: the JVM, the class library and tools such as `javac`, `jar`, `jshell`, `jcmd`. §1.3
- **JEP** — JDK Enhancement Proposal: the numbered document describing a new feature. §1.12, §17.1

- **JFR (JDK Flight Recorder)** — Low-overhead event recording built into the JVM, for production profiling. §16.10
- **JIT compiler** — Just-in-time compiler that turns hot bytecode into optimised machine code while the program runs. §1.7, §16.8
- **`jlink`** — Builds a custom runtime image containing only the modules an application needs. §16.12
- **JMH** — The Java Microbenchmark Harness, which handles warm-up, forks and dead-code elimination for benchmarks. §16.9
- **JPMS** — The Java Platform Module System (Java 9): `module-info.java` with `requires`, `exports`, `opens`. §16.12
- **JRE** — Java Runtime Environment: the JVM plus class library, enough to run but not compile programs; since Java 11 Oracle ships only the JDK (trimmed runtimes are built with `jlink`). §1.3
- **`jshell`** — The Java REPL (Java 9) for trying expressions interactively. §1.9
- **`jstack`** — Prints a thread dump of a running JVM. §16.10
- **JUnit** — The standard Java testing framework; tests are methods annotated `@Test`. §18.4
- **JVM** — Java Virtual Machine: loads, verifies and runs bytecode, manages memory and threads. §1.3, §16.1

K

- **Key derivation function API** — `javax.crypto.KDF` (Java 25) for deriving keys, e.g. with HKDF. §17.10

L

- **Label** — A name before a loop (`outer:`) that `break` or `continue` can target. §3.9
- **Lambda expression** — An anonymous function, `(params) -> body`, implementing a functional interface. §11.2
- **Lazy evaluation** — Deferring work until a result is needed; streams do nothing until a terminal operation runs. §12.2
- **`LinkedHashMap`** — A hash map that keeps insertion (or access) order; the basis of a simple LRU cache. §10.4
- **`LinkedList`** — A doubly linked `List` and `Deque`; O(1) at the ends, O(n) indexing. §10.2
- **Livelock** — Threads keep changing state in response to each other but make no progress. §15.9
- **Load factor** — The fullness ratio (default 0.75) at which a `HashMap` doubles its table. §10.5
- **Local class** — A class declared inside a method body. §6.11
- **Local variable type inference** — `var` (Java 10): the compiler infers a local variable's type from its initializer. §2.6
- **`LocalDate`** — A date without time or zone, e.g. `2025-03-09`. §7.9
- **`LocalDateTime`** — A date and time without a zone. §7.9
- **Lock elision** — The JIT removing locking on objects proved not to escape their thread. §16.8
- **Logging** — Recording events with a level and logger name to configurable destinations (SLF4J, Logback, `java.util.logging`). §18.10
- **`long`** — The 64-bit signed integer primitive, about $\pm 9.2 \times 10^{18}$. §2.3
- **LRU cache** — A cache that evicts the least-recently-used entry; built with an access-ordered `LinkedHashMap`. §10.4
- **LTS release** — A long-term-support Java release (8, 11, 17, 21, 25) that vendors patch for years. §1.12

M

- **`main` method** — The program entry point: classically `public static void main(String[] args)`. §4.9
- **`Map`** — A key → value collection with unique keys; not a subtype of `Collection`. §10.4
- **`Math`** — Utility class for arithmetic: `abs`, `pow`, `sqrt`, `round`, `floorMod`, `clamp`, `*Exact`. §7.5
- **Maven** — A build tool driven by `pom.xml`, with a fixed lifecycle of phases and a central repository. §18.2

- **Memory leak (Java)** — Objects that are no longer needed but stay reachable, so the GC can't free them. §16.11
- **Metaspace** — Native memory holding class metadata (replaced PermGen in Java 8). §16.3
- **Method** — A named block of code in a class that can take parameters and return a value. §4.1
- **Method overloading** — Several methods with the same name but different parameter lists, chosen at compile time. §4.3
- **Method overriding** — A subclass providing its own implementation of an inherited instance method, chosen at run time. §6.3
- **Method reference** — Shorthand for a lambda that calls one method: `String::length`, `System.out::println`, `ArrayList::new`. §11.4
- **Method signature** — A method's name plus its parameter types. §4.1
- **Mock** — A test double that records calls and returns programmed answers (e.g. with Mockito). §18.6
- **Mockito** — The most widely used Java mocking library: `mock`, `when(...).thenReturn`, `verify`. §18.6
- **Module** — A named, self-describing group of packages declared in `module-info.java`. §16.12
- **Module import declaration** — `import module java.base;` (Java 25): imports every package a module exports. §17.10
- **Monitor** — The lock every Java object has, used by `synchronized`, `wait` and `notify`. §14.6
- **Multi-catch** — `catch (A \| B e)` — one handler for several unrelated exception types. §8.5
- **Mutable** — Able to change state after creation. §5.9

N

- **Narrowing conversion** — Converting to a type with a smaller range (`long` → `int`); requires a cast and may lose information. §2.7
- **Nested class** — A class declared inside another; static nested or inner. §6.10
- **NIO.2** — The `java.nio.file` API (Java 7): `Path`, `Files`, `FileSystem`, `WatchService`. §13.1
- **`null`** — The reference value meaning "no object". §2.5
- **`NullPointerException`** — Thrown when code uses a `null` reference as if it pointed to an object. §8.1

O

- **Object** — An instance of a class, with state (fields) and behaviour (methods), living on the heap. §5.1
- **`Object` class** — The root of every class hierarchy; defines `equals`, `hashCode`, `toString`, `getClass`, `wait`, `notify`. §6.2, §6.13
- **`Optional`** — A container holding one value or none; a return type for "maybe no result". §11.7
- **Ordinal** — An enum constant's zero-based position in its declaration (`ordinal()`). §6.9
- **`OutOfMemoryError`** — Thrown when the JVM can't allocate memory in the heap, metaspace or native memory. §16.3

P

- **Package** — A namespace grouping related types, declared with `package`; mirrors the directory structure. §5.4
- **Package-private** — The default access (no modifier): visible within the same package only. §5.6
- **Parallel GC** — A throughput collector that uses many threads in stop-the-world pauses. §16.5
- **Parallel stream** — A stream whose work is split across the common `ForkJoinPool`; only worth it for large CPU-bound tasks. §12.8
- **Parameterized test** — A test run once per set of arguments (`@ParameterizedTest` with a source). §18.5
- **Pass-by-value** — Java always copies the argument value into the parameter; for objects, the value copied is the reference. §4.2
- **`Path`** — An NIO.2 object naming a file-system location; doesn't touch the disk by itself. §13.2
- **Pattern matching** — Testing a value's shape and extracting parts in one step: type, record and unnamed patterns. §3.5, §3.6, §3.7
- **PECS** — "Producer `extends`, consumer `super`": the wildcard rule for flexible generic APIs. §9.6

- **`Period`** — A `java.time` amount in years, months and days (e.g. `P1Y2M5D`). §7.9
- **Permitted subclass** — A class listed in a sealed type's `permits` clause. §6.7
- **Pinning** — A virtual thread blocking without unmounting, holding its carrier; `synchronized` no longer pins since Java 24. §15.5
- **Platform thread** — A Java thread backed one-to-one by an OS thread. §15.4
- **Polymorphism** — One reference type, many run-time behaviours: a call runs the implementation of the object's actual class. §6.4
- **Precedence** — The order in which operators bind (`*` before `+`, `&&` before `\|\|`). §2.9
- **`PreparedStatement`** — A pre-compiled JDBC statement with `?` parameters; prevents SQL injection. §18.11
- **Preview feature** — A complete feature that may still change; needs `--enable-preview` on `javac` and `java`. §1.12, §17.1
- **Primitive stream** — `IntStream`, `LongStream` or `DoubleStream`, which avoid boxing and add `sum`/`average`. §12.6
- **Primitive type** — One of the eight built-in value types: `byte`, `short`, `int`, `long`, `float`, `double`, `char`, `boolean`. §2.3
- **`PriorityQueue`** — A binary-heap queue that always removes the smallest element (by natural order or a comparator). §10.6
- **`private`** — Access modifier: visible only inside the declaring top-level class. §5.6
- **Promotion (numeric)** — Automatic widening of `byte`, `short` and `char` to `int` (or to the wider operand type) in arithmetic. §2.7
- **`protected`** — Access modifier: visible in the package and to subclasses. §5.6

R

- **Race condition** — A result that depends on the timing of threads, e.g. lost updates from `count++`. §14.5
- **Raw type** — A generic type used without type arguments (`List`); disables generic type checking. §9.7
- **Reachability** — An object is live if a chain of references leads to it from a GC root. §16.5
- **`ReadWriteLock`** — A lock pair allowing many concurrent readers or one writer. §14.9
- **Record** — A concise immutable data carrier (Java 16) with generated constructor, accessors, `equals`, `hashCode`, `toString`. §6.8
- **Record pattern** — A pattern that deconstructs a record: `case Point(int x, int y)` (Java 21). §3.7
- **Recursion** — A method calling itself; needs a base case to stop. §4.5
- **Reduction** — Combining stream elements into one result with `reduce` or a collector. §12.4
- **`ReentrantLock`** — An explicit reentrant lock with `tryLock`, timeouts, fairness and conditions. §14.9
- **Reference type** — Any non-primitive type; variables hold references to objects (or `null`). §2.5
- **Reflection** — Inspecting and using classes, methods and fields at run time (`getClass()`, `java.lang.reflect`). §16.2
- **Regular expression** — A pattern language for matching text, used by `split`, `replaceAll`, `matches`, `Pattern`. §7.2
- **REPL** — Read-eval-print loop: an interactive prompt such as `jshell`. §1.9
- **Resource leak** — Failing to close a file, socket or connection; prevented by try-with-resources. §8.6, §13.13
- **`Runnable`** — A task interface with `void run()` and no result. §14.2
- **`RuntimeException`** — The superclass of unchecked exceptions. §8.2

S

- **Scalar replacement** — Replacing a non-escaping object's fields with local variables so it's never allocated. §16.8
- **Scoped value** — An immutable value bound for the duration of a call and readable by code it invokes (final in Java 25). §15.6

- **Sealed class** — A class or interface (Java 17) that lists its permitted subclasses with `permits`. §6.7
- `Semaphore` — A synchronizer handing out a fixed number of permits to limit concurrent access. §14.13
- **Sequenced collection** — Java 21 interfaces (`SequencedCollection`, `SequencedSet`, `SequencedMap`) with `getFirst`, `getLast`, `reversed`. §10.11
- **Serial GC** — A single-threaded, stop-the-world collector for small heaps. §16.5
- **Serialization** — Converting objects to bytes with `ObjectOutputStream`; risky with untrusted data. §13.10
- `serialVersionUID` — The version number checked when deserialising a `Serializable` class. §13.10
- `Set` — A collection with no duplicate elements. §10.3
- **Shadowing** — A local variable or parameter hiding a field with the same name; use `this.name` to reach the field. §5.2
- **Shallow immutability** — Fields can't be reassigned, but the objects they refer to may still be mutable (true of records). §5.9, §6.8
- **Shenandoah** — A low-pause OpenJDK collector that compacts concurrently. §16.5
- **Short-circuit evaluation** — `&&` and `\|\|` skip the right operand when the left decides the result; also short-circuiting stream operations. §2.8, §12.4
- **Single-file source launch** — Running `java Hello.java` without a separate compile step (Java 11). §1.10
- **SLF4J** — Simple Logging Facade for Java: a logging API with pluggable backends such as Logback. §18.10
- **Stack (JVM)** — Per-thread memory of frames for active method calls, holding locals and partial results. §16.3
- **Stack trace** — The list of method frames active when an exception was created, newest first. §8.9
- `StackOverflowError` — Thrown when a thread's stack is exhausted, usually by runaway recursion. §4.5, §16.3
- **Starvation** — A thread never gets the CPU or lock it needs because others always win. §15.9
- `static` — Belonging to the class rather than to an instance; one copy shared by all. §5.5
- **Static nested class** — A nested class declared `static`; it has no enclosing instance. §6.10
- **Stop-the-world pause** — A GC phase during which all application threads are paused. §16.5
- **Stream** — A lazy, one-shot pipeline of operations over a source of elements (`java.util.stream`). §12.1
- **Stream gatherers** — See *gatherer*. §12.9
- `String` — An immutable sequence of UTF-16 characters. §2.12, §7.1
- **String pool** — The JVM table of shared `String` objects for literals and interned strings. §7.1
- **String templates** — A preview feature in Java 21 and 22 that was withdrawn in Java 23. §17.8
- `StringBuilder` — A mutable, unsynchronised character buffer for building strings efficiently. §7.3
- **Strong encapsulation** — Since Java 17 JDK internals are inaccessible by default; `--add-opens` is required to reach them. §17.3
- **Structured concurrency** — Treating a group of concurrent subtasks as one unit (`StructuredTaskScope`); still preview in Java 25. §15.7
- `super` — Refers to the parent class: `super.method()` calls the parent's version, `super(...)` its constructor. §6.1
- **Suppressed exception** — An exception from `close()` attached to the primary exception in try-with-resources. §8.6
- **Surrogate pair** — Two `char`s encoding one Unicode character outside the Basic Multilingual Plane (many emoji). §7.2
- `switch` **expression** — A `switch` that yields a value (Java 14), using arrow labels or `yield`. §3.3
- `synchronized` — Keyword that acquires an object's monitor for a method or block, giving mutual exclusion and visibility. §14.6
- **Synchronizer** — A coordination object such as a latch, barrier, semaphore or phaser. §14.13

T

- **Terminal operation** — The stream operation that produces a result and triggers execution (`collect`, `count`, `forEach`). §12.4
- **Ternary operator** — `cond ? a : b` — the conditional expression. §2.8
- **Test double** — Any stand-in for a real collaborator in a test: dummy, stub, fake, spy or mock. §18.6
- **Text block** — A multi-line string literal delimited by `"""` (Java 15). §2.12
- **`this`** — A reference to the current object; `this(...)` calls another constructor. §5.2, §5.3
- **Thread** — An independent path of execution within a process, sharing the heap with other threads. §14.1
- **Thread dump** — A snapshot of every thread's state and stack; shows deadlocks. §16.10
- **Thread pool** — A set of reusable worker threads that execute submitted tasks. §14.11
- **`ThreadLocal`** — A variable with an independent value per thread. §15.6
- **Thread-safe** — Behaving correctly when used by several threads at once without extra coordination by callers. §14.1, §14.14
- **`throw` / `throws`** — `throw` raises an exception; `throws` in a method signature declares checked exceptions it may raise. §8.3, §8.7
- **`Throwable`** — The root class of everything that can be thrown: `Error` and `Exception`. §8.2
- **Tiered compilation** — Running code in the interpreter, then C1, then C2 as it gets hotter. §1.7
- **`toString`** — Returns a text representation; `Object`'s default is `ClassName@hash`. §6.13
- **`TreeMap` / `TreeSet`** — Red-black-tree map/set kept in sorted order, O(log n), with navigation methods such as `floorKey`. §10.4, §10.3
- **try-with-resources** — `try (Resource r = …)`, which closes every declared `AutoCloseable` automatically, in reverse order. §8.6
- **Type erasure** — Compiling generics by checking types and then removing type arguments, inserting casts. §9.7
- **Type inference** — The compiler deducing types (`var`, diamond, generic method arguments, lambda parameters). §2.6, §9.4
- **Type parameter** — A placeholder type such as `T` in `class Box<T>`. §9.2

U

- **Unboxing** — Converting a wrapper object back to its primitive; unboxing `null` throws `NullPointerException`. §7.6
- **Unchecked exception** — `RuntimeException`, `Error` and their subclasses — not checked by the compiler. §8.2
- **Unchecked warning** — A compiler warning that a generic operation can't be type-checked (raw types, unchecked casts). §9.8
- **`UncheckedIOException`** — An unchecked wrapper for `IOException`, used inside lambdas and streams. §13.4
- **Unicode** — The universal character set; Java strings use the UTF-16 encoding of it. §7.2
- **Unmodifiable collection** — A collection whose mutators throw `UnsupportedOperationException`, such as `List.of`. §10.10
- **Unnamed variable `_`** — An underscore for a variable or pattern you don't use (Java 22). §3.7, §17.7
- **`UnsupportedOperationException`** — Thrown by an operation a collection or object doesn't support. §10.10
- **UTF-8** — A variable-length encoding using 1–4 bytes per character; the Java default charset since 18. §13.7

V

- **`var`** — Local variable type inference (Java 10). §2.6
- **Varargs** — A parameter `T... values` accepting zero or more arguments as an array. §4.4

- **Virtual thread** — A lightweight thread (Java 21) scheduled by the JVM onto carrier threads; cheap enough to create one per task. §15.4
- **Visibility (memory)** — Whether one thread's writes are guaranteed to be seen by another. §14.7, §15.8
- `volatile` — A field modifier guaranteeing visibility and ordering of reads and writes, but not atomic compound actions. §14.7

W

- `wait` / `notify` — `Object` methods for guarded blocks; must be called holding the object's monitor. §14.8
- **Weakly consistent iterator** — A concurrent-collection iterator that never throws CME and may or may not show concurrent updates. §14.12
- **Widening conversion** — Automatic conversion to a type with a larger range (`int` → `long` → `double`). §2.7
- **Wildcard** — `?` in a generic type: `List<?>`, `List<? extends T>`, `List<? super T>`. §9.6
- **Work stealing** — Idle threads taking tasks from the back of busy threads' queues, as `ForkJoinPool` does. §15.3
- **Wrapper class** — The object form of a primitive: `Integer`, `Long`, `Double`, `Character`, `Boolean`, … §7.6

Y

- `yield` — Returns a value from a block inside a `switch` expression. §3.3

Z

- **ZGC** — A scalable low-latency collector with sub-millisecond pauses; generational-only since Java 24. §16.5
- `ZonedDateTime` — A date-time with a time-zone region, aware of daylight-saving rules. §7.10

Chapter TL;DR

- **Types**: eight primitives with fixed sizes (`int` ±2.1 × 10^9, `long` ±9.2 × 10^{18}, `char` 0–65 535); integer overflow wraps silently; `0.1 + 0.2 != 0.3`; money in `BigDecimal` built from strings.
- **Equality**: `==` compares references for objects; use `equals` — the `Integer` cache (−128…127) and the string pool only make `==` *look* right.
- **Modern syntax**: switch expressions, pattern matching with guards, record patterns and `_`, sealed types for exhaustive switches, records for data, `var` for locals, text blocks.
- **Collections**: `ArrayList` and `HashMap` by default, `ArrayDeque` for stacks and queues, `TreeMap` for order and ranges, `LinkedHashMap` for LRU; `List.of` is unmodifiable and rejects `null`.
- **Functional and streams**: `Supplier`/`Consumer`/`Predicate`/`Function`; streams are lazy and one-shot; `groupingBy`, `partitioningBy`, `toMap` (duplicates throw); gatherers in 24; `Optional` only as a return type.
- **Exceptions**: checked = recoverable and declared, unchecked = bugs; try-with-resources closes in reverse and keeps close failures as suppressed; never `return` from `finally`.
- **Concurrency**: `synchronized`/locks for mutual exclusion, `volatile` for visibility only, atomics and `ConcurrentHashMap` for counters and caches, `CompletableFuture` for composition, virtual threads for blocking I/O at scale; happens-before decides visibility.
- **JVM**: heap, stacks, metaspace, code cache; G1 by default, ZGC for low latency; `-Xmx`, `-Xlog:gc*`, heap dumps on OOM; `jcmd`, JFR, `jstack` to diagnose.
- **Versions**: 17 sealed · 21 virtual threads, pattern `switch`, record patterns, sequenced collections · 22 `_`, FFM · 24 gatherers · 25 compact source files, module imports, flexible constructors, scoped values. Structured concurrency is still preview.

- **Tools**: `mvn clean verify` / `./gradlew build`, JUnit + Mockito + AssertJ, SLF4J for logging, `PreparedStatement` for SQL.
- **Next**: Spring Boot (or Jakarta EE, Quarkus), Kotlin if you like, and the LLD, SQL and DDIA notes — then build something real.